

FINAL REPORT



Fifth General Service Conference of A. A.



1955

INDEX TO 1955 GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE REPORT

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE	1
BILL AND THE NIGHT VISITORS	3
THE PARADOXES OF A.A. (Bernard B. Smith, Chairman)	6
REPORTS	
Summary of Conference Activity	9
Highlights of Financial Statements	10
General Service Headquarters Operations	11
Public Relations Policy and Practice	12
The General Service Representative Plan	13
Institutional Groups (Prisons & Hospitals)	14
Overseas Groups and Internationalists	15
The A.A. Grapevine	16
The Trustees of the General Service Board	17
20th Anniversary Convention Committee	18
POLICY SESSIONS	
Listing of Delegates in Directory	19
Ratio of Alcoholic to Non-Alcoholic Trustees	19
Principle of Rotation (Ex-Trustees)	20
Anonymity Resolution	21
Discontinuance of Conference Fund	22
Permanent Charter Adopted	23
"AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING	27
PANEL SESSIONS	
G. S. R. Plan for A.A. Groups	28
Prison and Hospital Sponsorship Programs	29
BILL'S WRITING PROJECT	30
"QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS"	31
CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS	35
APPENDICES	
I Conference Agenda (Digest)	41
II Financial Statements	42
III Roster of Delegates	51
IV Trustees and Headquarters Staff	53
V Contributions to General Service Headquarters	54
VI Contributions to Conference Fund	56
VII "Grapevine" Circulation	58
VIII Committees of the Conference	59

(Additional copies of this report available at \$1.00
per copy through General Service Conference Delegates,
Committeemen or Group Representatives)

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

What was the sense of the 1955 General Service Conference? What did it accomplish? What single major idea can be said to have cut across all the formal deliberations and the informal give-and-take around the coffee urns?

It is relatively easy to determine what the Conference accomplished. By its unanimous adoption of a permanent Charter for the Conference structure, those who met in St. Louis in 1955 erected a monument to all the men and women who have served as Delegates since 1951. This was a real accomplishment, with consequences that almost inevitably will be lasting and beneficial as long as still-suffering alcoholics may need our program.

But action without awareness can be meaningless. Action for the sake of prestige, or merely as a flexing of intellectual muscles, could be dangerous to men who are bound together by strange catalysts---humility and the need to serve.

So perhaps the most significant element about the 1955 Conference was its repeated and collective awareness of what it was doing, of the future implications of the thoughts expressed, the interpretations rendered and the resolutions adopted at St. Louis.

As Bill so often and so eloquently reminded the Delegates, A. A. had truly come of age as it moved into its twenty-first year. It was significant that Bill did not have to spell out for them an important corollary. And that is the fact that the reaching of maturity does not in itself solve problems. It only makes men more aware of problems, leaving them to search their own experience and their own conscience for the best solution. It only makes men more aware that few social contracts among human beings are simple except in conception.

In 1951 the Delegates had met in the first Conference in an atmosphere of promise and eagerness to serve. The implied promise was that the recovered alcoholics of the world would one day write a social contract with the future, a contract binding them never to forget their obligations to the problem drinkers who might one day turn to them.

In retrospect, one senses that there was an element of tentativeness about the promise and the exact date when the contract would be executed. For the early members of Conference were largely men who were unaware of the scope of the founders' Third Legacy of Service. They were, to a large degree, unaware of the threats to that service from within and without the movement. Many were self-admittedly unaware of what was happening in A. A. in sections beyond their local areas.

To be unaware does not mean to be unwise--or unprincipled. The early delegates, like all who followed later, had the common bond of the principles of the Twelve Steps

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

and the Twelve Traditions. They had the collective wisdom to want to move slowly, to seek certainty rather than compromise, as Bernard Smith so often phrased it, in all matters seriously affecting the structure or the services of A.A. They were men, and later, women, in no hurry to affix their signatures to a contract with the future.

It is not unfair to the early panels to suggest that great courage was required of the Fifth General Service Conference when they spoke to the future in their adoption of a permanent Charter to assure the survival of this unique fellowship of service. For these men and women were speaking out of their awareness of the responsibilities that coming of age thrust upon human beings and human institutions.

It requires little or no courage to take action when one is unaware of the consequences that may ensue, or of problems that still remain to be solved.

Delegates to the Fifth Conference reflected a deep awareness that the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous will always be a society of fallible human beings attempting to act in accordance with great spiritual principles. They showed their fear that "practical," material considerations might one day encroach upon the spiritual. They were equally concerned with the possibility that distorted emphasis on those things of the spirit that are priceless to us might, in its own way, dissipate the founders' legacy of Service.

In less dedicated men and women, this awareness of complex problems might have obscured visions of hope for the future. It might have left them indecisive, unable to take those first steps upon which all great enterprises depend.

But now the first steps have been taken. The great enterprise lies ahead. Henceforth, the Third Legacy of World Service will have a new meaning for those who are in the fellowship today and for those who may seek its help tomorrow.

A.A. has indeed executed its social contract with the future.

BILL AND THE NIGHT VISITORS

This is a story told out of turn, of a meeting that was never considered for the agenda of the Fifth General Service Conference. If it deserves a place in the record, that is because it suggests, more eloquently than any formal vote or advisory action, the responsibilities inherent in the third legacy of service which now is passed into the hands of the Conference and, through it, into the hands of all who comprise our fellowship.

(It is a story retailed by a narrator who was only accidentally a witness to a fragment of the scene.)

The time was the evening of the first day of the Conference, that period when the agenda was reserved to area Delegates exclusively. It was an evening of open time for Bill, for members of the Headquarters staff, for those Trustees who had already joined the burgeoning throng in St. Louis. It was an evening when Bill, facing a week that was sure to drain emotional and physical resources, might have been forgiven for seeking the companionship of a small gathering, or the deeper comfort of solitude itself.

Those intimate privileges were not to be his that evening. Instead, unknown to most, Bill was a participant in a meeting at which no notes were taken, no rules of order invoked, no decisions solemnly recorded.

In a little-used room off the beaten path of the Jefferson Hotel's main traffic, Bill sat on one side of a long, green-covered table. Encircling him were perhaps ten or a dozen men who cannot be identified except to indicate that they were men of disciplined minds, questing and compassionate hearts and high status in their community.

Through one of their number who knew and applauded A.A., they had sought the privilege of meeting Bill, of talking with him of this recovery program whose earliest courier he had been. They sought, also, (it may be assumed) the right to ask all manner of questions.

They did not all arrive in one group---but singly and by twos and threes. They approached quietly by way of an outer room, quickly concluded the amenities of recognition or introduction and joined those who had preceded them at the green table.

The first night visitors arrived at nine o'clock. Occasionally a visitor would leave, only to be succeeded minutes later by another arrival. Ten o'clock passed. There was a brief break in the meeting and then, through the closed door, once more was heard the faint rhythm of questions asked and answered, the blurred roar of hearty laughter and the occasional clinking of an ash tray.

BILL AND THE NIGHT VISITORS
(Continued)

Eleven o'clock passed. The indistinct hum of voices continued. By now the one scheduled meeting of the Conference had dissolved. By now most of the Headquarters people had put down their last coffee cups of the day and were groping for the awkward bulk of their room keys. By now, more sophisticated members might have reasoned, Bill had given amply of his time and had earned the right to escape to personal privacy. But the meeting continued.

Midnight came and passed. Moving down the deserted corridor, a watchman tested the door gently and then withdrew, perhaps perplexed by the strange scene. For this must have seemed an odd meeting. The trappings of men seeking simple answers from one of their number are simple indeed and almost forgotten these days.

For these are times when the overstuffed briefcase, the sharpened pencils and pristine pads, are too often the conventional symbols of meetings.

There were none of these in the room with the green table. This was a meeting of minds and hearts, a giving and taking of experience, a tentative search for deep truths that may one day be shared without reserve by all who would heal themselves and others, so that the greatest purposes of life may be realized.

Well past the hour, the meeting came to an end. The tall, lanky man called Bill moved slowly to the door with his new friends---these people who had come in all humility to ask questions about this thing called Alcoholics Anonymous and to try to relate it to their own experience and knowledge and insights.

Bill moved through the door and the night visitors with him, chatting the small talk with which those who meet for the first time work toward common roots of experience and thinking.

And the thought occurred to one who witnessed what might be deemed an isolated, minor incident---the thought occurred that perhaps this meeting testified to the need for the General Service Conference which had brought so many A.A. members to St. Louis in this momentous week.

For A.A., as a promise and demonstration of the possibility of man's redemption from depths of his own making, will probably always have night visitors who would ask privately about that which we offer freely. And we do not have the right to ask why such visitors do not gather with us by day in public places. We have only the responsibility to be sure that, when Bill is no longer among us, we shall have a structure to which all visitors can turn and find inscribed those few and simple truths to which we owe so much.

The burden of building this structure and of inscribing what we have learned, and what we may learn tomorrow, may well divert us from more attractive pursuits.

BILL AND THE NIGHT VISITORS
(Continued)

Some visitors may be those who would come to scoff or to mutilate the principles of experience we have inscribed. Some may seek to destroy the structure itself, which must be built to withstand the malicious as well as the uninformed, those who would permit decay from within as well as those who approach from beyond the walls.

In our own past, searching for sobriety, seeking to maintain it, we too have known what it meant to be a visitor in the night. We have gone forth seeking help. And we have gone forth to pass that help along.

Looking outward, conscious of our need to reach out to those who have understanding or need it, we may perhaps have limited our conception of the Twelfth Step. Unlike Bill, we may unconsciously believe that the Twelfth Step points only in one direction---away from us and out to our brother.

But the steps of the night visitors come toward us and we must have a haven where these people can always find answers they seek, always find private refuge, if they require it, always find the gift of our time, our interest and our willingness to share.

Thus we build this structure of the General Service Conference not for ourselves, although the house is ours in name, but for those unknown travelers who knock upon our door, by day or by night, for all time to come. We build it not to adorn mere men or women but to house simple learnings and to illuminate them.

Less than a generation ago, there were few doors toward which the alcoholic or his family or his friends could turn their steps. A generation hence Bill may not be with us to stand at the door of the house we are building this week. But the house must be there and it must stand strong. And the door of the house must always be open.

For the steps of him who seeks our shelter, to us shall always be those of our brother.

THE PARADOXES OF A.A.

Excerpts from Closing Talk by Bernard B. Smith, Chairman, General Service Board

We are here not to minister to our own sobriety but rather, in keeping with our concept of service, to insure that the structure of A.A. within which we fought our way back to life is rendered indestructible.

Our own sobriety may not be threatened by what we do here but if we fail in our efforts to insulate the structure of A.A. from the dangers of human fallibility, millions of people destined to alcoholism will never find the key that can unlock the door of their alcoholic dungeon.

This completion of the structure of A.A. today is therefore akin to a collective Twelfth Step...an assurance by this first generation of A.A. to succeeding generations that this great spiritual means for attaining and maintaining sobriety is preserved for their use and their liberation.

Some of us, when we become accustomed to sobriety, may overlook the message to society that is implicit in those tenets of faith, the following of which lifted us from the descending path that led to dissolution and destruction to the spiritually ascending path that led to sobriety. For we, in the great laboratory of A.A., have established as a basic truth for this materialistic age that living in terms of human decency, of honesty, of humility and of friendship is the true life and that living by the materialistic ideals of a society that almost destroyed us is the illusory one.

In the sharp line that is drawn between the illusory life that most men live and from which we were liberated, and the real life which we now live, there are found many paradoxes. Take the simple statement: "I am an alcoholic." The first time a man or woman stands before us and says: "I am an alcoholic," he says it when he no longer drinks alcohol. Thus, when the time comes that we describe ourselves as alcoholics, society ceases to regard us as such. And yet it is only at the moment when we cease to drink that we assert the right to describe ourselves as alcoholics.

When we lived in terms of the society from which we were liberated and that society, in the years of our excessive drinking, referred to us as alcoholics, we refused to accept this description and definition. Yet when we for the first time, having ceased to drink, cried out to ourselves and to the world in all humility, "We are alcoholics," that society refused to define us as such.

What an unthinking world may look upon as defeat, we know as a triumph, a triumph of the spirit, a triumph of humility over false pride and self-centeredness. How few human beings ever have the courage to stand up before their neighbors and in all humility say to them: "This is what I really am!"

There are two moments in which the utterance of the words "I am an alcoholic" has great significance.

THE PARADOXES OF A.A.
(Continued)

I have talked of the moment when one of us, for the first time, stands before an A.A. meeting and says: "I am an alcoholic." There is, however, another and earlier time which is of perhaps even greater significance. That is the moment when we say to our sponsor, in the darkness and desperation of our souls, "I am an alcoholic." And this moment points to another paradox in A.A.

The paradox in A.A. is that we do not approach our suffering alcoholic brother from the superiority and strength of our position but from the realization of our own weakness. We talk to him not of our strength but of our weakness. We talk not of how misguided he is but of how misguided we were. We sit not in judgment of him but in judgment of what we once were.

There is a third paradox in A.A. that stems directly from our Twelfth Step and yet relates itself to this same moment of contact with our suffering brother. All of us recall the well-known war bond slogan: "Give till it hurts." We in A.A. paradoxically pronounce the statement: "Don't give if it hurts." For we have found that we can give to, and invest our suffering brother with, that which we have only when we experience the joy of giving, a giving that is a taking as well, a giving in which a sense of "giving up" anything, a sense of sacrifice, is fatal. For we have found that when there is no joy in the giving and the sharing of the message which brought us our recovery, we lose the power to give.

Society, in referring to the alcoholic, employs the expression, "the enslavement of alcohol." For us, this statement is in a very special sense paradoxical too, if indeed it is true at all. In sober fact we were never enslaved by alcohol. Alcohol simply served as an escape for us from our enslavement to the false ideals of a materialistic society. Yet if we accept society's definition of our former state as the enslavement of alcohol, we can no longer resent this enslavement, for it has served to set us free from all the materialistic traps with which the paths through the jungle of our society is set. For we first had to face materialism as a disease of society before we could free ourselves of the illness of alcoholism and be free of the social ills that had made us alcoholics.

We who used alcohol as an escape are not the only ones who are afraid of life, hostile to the world, fleeing from it into loneliness. Millions who are not alcoholics are living today in illusory worlds, nurturing the basic anxieties and insecurities of human existence rather than face themselves with courage and humility. To these people we can offer as a cure no magic potion, no chemical formula, no powerful drug. We can only demonstrate to them, if we are asked, how to use the primitive tools of humility, honesty, devotion and love, which indeed are the heart of our Twelve Steps.

There is still another paradoxical statement of human society which has a special application to A.A. That statement is the saying that "a chain is as strong as its weakest link." The accepted connotation is that a chain is strong only if it has no

THE PARADOXES OF A.A.
(Continued)

weak links. The paradox of this statement as applied to A.A. is that, in A.A., in truth the chain is as strong as its weakest link. For the endless chain of A.A. grows in strength to the extent that we are able to reach the weak links, our still-suffering alcoholic brothers and sisters. It is in this paradoxical statement that the assurance of the survival of our society rests. The perpetuation of our society is grounded in the so-called weakness of those human beings who escape the materialistic bases of society through the medium of alcohol.

As we here today complete what we hope will prove an indestructible structure for A.A. we are providing for the sick societies of tomorrow. If we succeed in constructing our edifice soundly, we insure the existence not only of a means of recovery of future generations of alcoholics, but a means which the sick societies of tomorrow can use, if they will, to rebuild themselves into healthy organisms. They need only watch the demonstration of our use of the primitive tools of humility, honesty, devotion and love...our Twelve Steps.

It is because we know of the tremendous impact that A.A. can have on the generations that will follow us that we have been so painstaking in the completion of the structure of A.A.---a structure that Bill so aptly describes as a legacy.

But this legacy has a string to it. And that "string" is that we are granted the use of this legacy for our lifetime upon the condition that we not only look after it but increase its spiritual content for the generations that will follow us, and each succeeding generation, as it receives this legacy, must also protect it if they wish to employ it and gain life by it and pass the legacy on with a similarly increased spiritual content.

This first generation in the life of A.A. now draws to a close. It is rich in its faith, large in its numbers and dedicated to its purposes. It leaves to human society a legacy that we who have journeyed to St. Louis have been privileged to see completed. Yet we have here been granted only the right to continue to give and to labor and to preserve and to enhance the great structure of A.A. And we must exert ourselves in the years that are still left to us to increasingly insulate this great structure from the ravages of human fallibility.

If we succeed, generations from now men and women standing before A.A. groups around the world, repeating the words we have so often said ourselves--"I am an alcoholic"--will talk of this generation of A.A. and of this day in St. Louis. And they will say, as they talk of our suffering and of our deliverance, "Yes, in their suffering they thought they suffered for their own deliverance; in fact, they suffered for ours."

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE SECRETARY

Participation of Conference Delegates in shaping A.A.'s world services has been sought in two specific ways since adjournment of the 1954 Conference, Lib S. of the Headquarters Staff noted in her report:

1. Delegates have been asked to reflect the opinion of their A.A. areas on policy matters up for consideration at Service Headquarters.
2. Committees of the Conference have been called upon for specific decisions and services.

Two policy proposals were referred to Delegates during 1954. The first one, (Proposal #10) mailed in August, asked if the name and address of General Service Conference Delegates should be listed in the 1955 edition of the A.A. World Directory. Fifteen out of 76 Delegates acknowledged the inquiry, voting 13 to 2 for the proposal. Since the response could hardly be construed to reflect movement-wide opinion, the matter was deferred for further consideration at the 1955 Conference.

The second proposal, mailed to Delegates in November, related to a resolution on anonymity and was accompanied by a special memorandum from Bill. Forty-one replies favoring the resolution were received. Since this figure represented an affirmative vote of less than two-thirds of the Conference, no action was taken, pending convening of 1955 Delegates.

Also in November, a questionnaire was sent to all Delegates and Area Committeemen requesting information on the most recent Assembly in their area at which Conference personnel had been selected. A total of 153 replies were received from a mailing of approximately 650. Information culled from these replies was helpful in revising the section on Assemblies in the "Third Legacy Manual."

In March three proposals were mailed for area consideration prior to the June Conference. In May, following approval by the Conference Agenda Committee, the preliminary Agenda for the 1955 Conference was sent to Delegates.

Other projects involving contact with Conference Committees during the year included the 20th Anniversary Convention (seven Delegates represented on Committee) and preparation of "A.A. and the Medical Profession," reviewed in manuscript form by the Literature Committee.

HIGHLIGHTS OF FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

(Detailed financial statements of A.A.'s three service agencies are included in Appendix II of this report. Significant features of the three statements are summarized below).

The combined statement covering 1954 operations of A.A.'s three corporate agencies shows a net deficit of \$1,044 for the year, exclusive of an increase of \$13,932 in the Reserve Fund.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A. INC. (Formerly The Alcoholic Foundation.) The balance in the Reserve Fund now totals \$108,632. Group Contributions increased from \$113,056 in 1953 to \$117,190 in 1954 but this gain was offset by a rise in the total office expense chargeable for services to the groups. (From \$112,863 in 1953 to \$118,775 in 1954).

Conference Fund subscriptions from the Groups amounted to only \$9,383 against total Conference costs of \$18,899 during the year.

General Fund expenses increased during the year, reflecting increased Headquarters activity, but income decreased and interest on savings accounts previously credited to the General Fund are now allocated to the Reserve Fund.

A.A. PUBLISHING, INC. Net Income decreased sharply during the year, from \$59,080 in 1953 to \$18,800 in 1954, due in part to increased costs and in large measure to the expected decline from the high initial volume of sales of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," which had been released for distribution in 1953.

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC. The monthly magazine netted \$4,840 for the fiscal year ending March 31, 1954 and was able to reduce to \$14,146 the deficit accumulated in prior years.

GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS OPERATIONS

The overall scope of General Service Headquarters operations during the past twelve months was indicated in the following statistical data presented to Delegates by Hank G.:

INCOMING MAIL ITEMS	35,116
(Inquiries, Group communications, Contributions, etc.)	
OUTGOING MAIL ITEMS	132,000
(Including Monthly Bulletins)	
PACKAGES WRAPPED AND SHIPPED	19,615
(32,393 books, 549,193 pamphlets, 119 record sets and 162,000 wallet cards)	

The Accounting Department processed 7,522 orders for books and pamphlets, handled 4,939 remittances for the Group Contribution Fund and 1,126 remittances for the Conference Fund.

To increase efficiency of service operations, modernization of both the office and shipping department facilities was completed during the year at a total cost of \$6,208.

As authorized by the 1954 Conference, a special symbol has been developed and is being used on all Conference-approved literature. Other Conference suggestions carried out during the year include the re-styling of A.A. literature and the submission to the Literature Committee of manuscripts of new pamphlets, the first one being "A.A. and the Medical Profession," placed in circulation last winter. As recommended, other items of literature have been consolidated, resulting in two new titles: "Alcoholism the Illness" and "A.A. Tradition - How it Developed" by Bill. The "Structure & Services" folder now incorporates material previously contained in "Your General Service." Literature distribution for 1954:

BOOKS	TOTAL	PAMPHLETS (Continued)	TOTAL
Alcoholics Anonymous	22,004	Sponsorship	26,047
Twelve Steps & Twelve Trad'ns	10,389	Young People and A. A.	29,017
PAMPHLETS		A. A. Traditions	14,991
A.A.-44 Questions & Answers . .	73,668	The Alcoholic Wife (New 3/54) . . .	23,981
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	34,890	Good Housekeeping Reprint (3/54) . .	24,553
The Alcoholic Employee	19,053	The Alcoholic Husband (New 3/54) . .	46,335
Sedatives & The Alcoholic . . .	23,514	The Third Legacy	5,694
Fortune Reprint	28,646	Your General Service (Discontinued) .	17,483
A.A. for the Woman	29,589	Medicine Looks at A.A. (Disc.) . . .	34,156
This Is A. A.	82,743	Society of A.A. (Disc.)	31,038
		About the Alcoholic Husband (Disc.) .	3,796

The current paid Headquarters staff consists of 5 full-time Staff Members, 2 persons in the Editorial & Research Division, 8 in Secretarial & General Office, 4 in Bookkeeping and 6 in Shipping. The "coordinator" is on a part-time basis.

PUBLIC RELATIONS POLICY AND PRACTICE

Movement-wide public relations activity for A.A. falls basically into two patterns: (1) handling of inquiries from outside A.A. and (2) interpreting the Fellowship's traditions at the public level, Eve M., told the Delegates in her report on the past year's operations.

Among the more dramatic inquiries received recently have been:

1. An approach by the Guidance Council of a branch of the armed services interested in encouraging extension of the A.A. program to bases in this country and overseas.
2. Inquiries from government officials in Mexico, Thailand and Turkey.

Application of the Sixth (No endorsement) and the Twelfth (Anonymity) Traditions to public relations practice during the past year was highlighted by the following:

1. Headquarters cooperation with the North American Newspaper Alliance syndicate, with Fawcett Publications and with the New York Daily News on stories proposed. In all cases, emphasis is on the fact that A.A. does not "promote" publicity, nor does it endorse specific articles.
2. Headquarters cooperation in John Daly's network television presentation on A.A. on his "Open Hearing" program. Substantial assistance was rendered by Grapevine personnel.
3. Continued correspondence and consultation with representatives of Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer studios over the projected filming of the Lillian Roth book, "I'll Cry Tomorrow," in which it is proposed to portray an A.A. member who deliberately breaks anonymity.

Based on evidence available at Headquarters, anonymity breaks appear to be declining, indicating the growing understanding of A.A. Tradition on the part of both our membership and communications media. Requests for background editorial material on A.A., as authorized by previous Delegates, continue to increase.

There is also growing evidence that A.A. members and outside agencies are increasingly willing to respect A.A.'s "personal anonymity" Tradition when the possibility of a "deviation" is pointed out to them.

GENERAL SERVICE REPRESENTATIVE PLAN

The first year's operation of the "General Service Representative Plan" approved by the 1954 Conference demonstrated the value of the basic idea but indicated clearly that certain modifications are needed, Lib S. of the Headquarters staff reported.

Development of the Plan following the last Conference was as follows:

1. In May, Staff members began to write to new groups and to "new" secretaries of established groups, informing them of the plan and inviting participation, if desired.
2. In late June, a detailed question-and-answer presentation of the plan was prepared. This material was distributed to all groups in July. Only a few responses were received.
3. Beginning in July, the question-and-answer material was distributed to all new groups (and to "new" secretaries).
4. In November, with the mailing of the 1955 Directory Information cards, U. S. and Canadian groups were asked to report the name and address of the General Service Representative, or the group's box number, and to indicate which listing they preferred in the Directory.

By late January it was evident that the request for G.S.R. names had created confusion in some A.A. areas. As a result of the many incorrect listings, additional clerical work was created in the Headquarters office.

Following publication of the 1955 World Directory in April, some Groups reported that their listings were incorrect (an inevitable consequence of errors in filling out the original Directory Information cards). The most frequent error appears to have been a tendency to list Group Secretaries where General Service Representatives should have been named.

As a result of the first year's enlightening experience, a careful analysis of the problems raised by the Plan has been made by Headquarters staff members. Several specific suggestions for modifying the plan, based on successful experience in areas where no confusion occurred, have been prepared for presentation to the Conference.

INSTITUTIONAL GROUPS (PRISONS AND HOSPITALS)

General Service Headquarters contacts with prison and hospital groups now extend to approximately 475 institutions in North America and overseas, Ann M. of the Headquarters staff reported. The majority, 275, are prison groups.

An outstanding recent development in this field has been the growth of institutional A.A. abroad. There are now eleven hospital groups in Australia (New South Wales, Queensland, Victoria and Western Australia), six in England, Ireland and Scotland and one in Chile. Plans are also being developed for similar groups in Germany, Africa and Japan.

In the correctional field, prison and work camp groups are now functioning in Australia, England, Hawaii, Puerto Rico and Africa, with others anticipated in the near future.

One of the highlights of correctional literature published during the past year was an article, "Alcoholics Anonymous in Prison" (by Eve M. of Headquarters Staff) in the December issue of Federal Probation, issued by the Administrative Office of the United States Courts in cooperation with the Bureau of Prisons of the Department of Justice. The article cited the increased confidence of prison officials in the A.A. program, evidenced by relaxation of regulations in certain maximum security prisons to admit the A.A. program.

As their prison publications disclose, inmate groups are keenly interested in A.A. outside their walls. Many groups contribute financially to the support of A.A. world services.

Two problems continue to pose a challenge:

1. The complex effects of dual drug and alcohol addiction as they relate to formation of successful inmate groups.
2. The need for planned programs of "outside" A.A. sponsorship of both the inmate group and the individual who is released from prison. (Service Headquarters has conducted a special survey of this problem, preliminary to its further consideration by the 1955 Conference.)

Throughout the past year, Service Headquarters has increased the scope of distribution of its "Prison Bulletin" and has added to its list of correspondents in both prison and hospital units.

OVERSEAS GROUPS AND INTERNATIONALISTS

A.A. continued to expand and grow in areas beyond North America during the past year, Marian F. of the Headquarters Staff reported. Foreign groups now number 441 in 63 countries and have an estimated membership of 10,650, an increase of 1,000 in twelve months.

Armed Forces personnel constitute the bulk of group membership in such areas as Germany, Japan and Korea. In Germany, however, there are definite indications that nationals are gradually becoming interested.

Headquarters service to foreign groups during the past year was featured by the translation of three Conference-approved pamphlets into six languages: Finnish, French, Norwegian, Portugese, Spanish and Swedish. The pamphlets selected were: "A.A. --44 Questions and Answers," "The Fortune Reprint" and "The Twelve Traditions," Bill's recent interpretations.

Limited permission to translate and reproduce other Conference-approved literature has been granted in specific instances. Restrictions take the form of requesting that the translations be distributed in mimeographed form only, bearing the legend "Reprinted by permission of A.A. Publishing, Inc., P. O. Box 459, Grand Central Annex, New York 17, N. Y., U. S. A. All rights reserved. Not for publication." These limitations are imposed solely for the purpose of protecting the fellowship's ownership of literature copyrights.

Interest in developing local translations has been evidenced in Finland, Norway, Sweden and Canada (French) but the greatest demand is for material in Spanish to serve the growing number of members in Central and South American countries.

As a service to Spanish-speaking groups, Headquarters assumed responsibility for printing 500 copies of a Spanish edition of the first section of the Big Book which had originally been translated and mimeographed privately. It is available for \$3.50.

During the past year Alanon Publications, Ltd., a British corporation, was formed in London and has published the Big Book for distribution in the Sterling area. Certain Conference-approved pamphlets are also being distributed through the same agency. This development will serve a large number of groups which had previously found it virtually impossible to remit funds to this country for A.A. literature.

A recent letter from a missionary in Thailand reports that the Twelve Steps have finally been translated in Thai, following many revisions required for the approval of local Buddhist authorities. A basic problem was to find a suitable expression of the concept of God "because the Buddhists, though not believing in God as such, still believe in a power above them which they variously name." In the Twelve Steps they have used a neutral word which means literally "things that we respect" and is accepted by Buddhists as the "Three in One" or "Holy Things."

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

A circulation gain of more than 3,000 copies during the past year, "the first significant increase in three years," highlighted operations of A.A.'s monthly international journal during the past twelve months, Don G., the magazine's new editor reported. Current circulation is in excess of 31,700 and the goal for the immediate future is "36 by '56"--(36,000 copies a month by January 1, 1956).

Noteworthy editorial developments, in accordance with suggestions from the 1954 Conference, may be summarized as follows:

- Publication of an increased number of articles of interest to older members.
- More illustrations per issue "by some of the top illustrators in the country."
- An attempt to reflect viewpoints of non-alcoholic spouses in "happy A.A. homes" and to indicate the relationship of Family Groups to the recovery program.
- Continued emphasis on A.A. history and on interpretations of the Twelve Steps.

As many as 80 to 100 manuscripts have been received in some months, approximately twice the number received in previous years.

In the black for the fourth consecutive year, The Grapevine maintained approximately the same ratio between operating cost and income that had marked the previous year's operations. (See financial details in Appendix.) Income increases were largely offset by the correction of serious inequities in the salaries of full-time professional personnel.

Group bulk sales now account for more than half of the total circulation but distribution of the magazine is still "spotty" throughout the fellowship. Only three groups in every ten now receive The Grapevine. "The financial security of the Grapevine effort is best assured by the yearly paid subscriptions for the obvious reason that they provide a solid, fixed income not subject to monthly fluctuations," the editor pointed out. An increase in this "fundamental source of financial security" should be encouraged if the magazine is to serve A.A. effectively, it was noted.

If only half of the more than 3,000 groups not now receiving the magazine were to order an average of three copies per month, the resulting increase of 4,700 copies would lift total circulation above 36,000 with little added operating expense.

More than 14,500 reprints of the famous serenity prayer cover were sold during the year. Reprint sales of Bill's special article on anonymity totalled more than 2,200.

BOARD OF TRUSTEES

The following is a summary of major decisions reached by the Board of Trustees of the General Service Board since the last General Service Conference, as reported by Cal M., Secretary:

1. Recorded these changes in A.A. personnel: E. D. (Icky) Sheridan replaced Earl Treat (term expired); Cal J. McCarthy, Jr. replaced Dan Hennessy (resigned); Dr. Leonard V. Strong, Jr. resigned - no replacement.
2. Approved the change in name of The Alcoholic Foundation to The General Service Board of A.A., Inc., as recommended by the 1954 General Service Conference, and simultaneously authorized the formation of a new corporation under the name of The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc., control and ownership of which would be vested in the General Service Board. The necessary legal steps were undertaken and were all completed by December of 1954.
3. Authorized the undertaking of a Twentieth Anniversary Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous in line with the recommendation of the 1954 General Service Conference.
4. Authorized A.A. Publishing, Inc., to conclude the agreement with Alanon Publications, Ltd. in Great Britain recognizing that copyright ownership of the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous" remains with the General Service Board of A.A., Inc. This agreement pertains to the British edition of the book. The agreement was concluded in line with this recommendation after legal consultation.
5. Authorized the translation and printing of the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous", into Norwegian after responsible A.A. representation in Norway has been established.
6. Authorized rejection of bequests and established a firm policy of continuing to do so.
7. Established a policy of depositing all reserve funds in Savings Banks in amounts not to exceed \$10,000 in any one institution.
8. Reviewed a report on "The Alcoholism and Drug Addiction Foundation, Inc.", a Connecticut corporation which had recently established an office in New York City. This organization is in the process of formation and is attempting to secure well-known industrialists and others for its Board of Directors.
9. Reviewed a report on the proposed motion picture of the Lillian Roth story, "I'll Cry Tomorrow" and authorized the Chairman of the Board to communicate with MGM, the producers.

TWENTIETH ANNIVERSARY CONVENTION COMMITTEE

The city of St. Louis was selected for the 20th Anniversary Convention of A.A. because of its facilities, availability and "somewhat central location geographically," the Convention Secretary reported.

The following were listed as members of the Committee, as approved by the General Service Board:

Bill Wilson, Archibald B. Roosevelt, Cal J. McCarthy, Jr., Marian G. Fiske, Secretary, Hank Grieme, Chairman, together with George C. Dyer, Chairman of local host activities in St. Louis and the following seven Delegates selected at the 1954 General Service Conference: Pete DeWeese, Mississippi, Jim Smith, Springfield, Massachusetts, Cy O'Neil, Montana, Ira Phelps, Corpus Christi, Texas, Leon Goode, Tennessee, Art Buchanan, Buffalo, New York and Bill Hanson, Wyoming. Ralph Bugli has served throughout as consultant.

Initially, Helen Brown Moran served as Convention Secretary and Dan Hennessy as a Trustee member, both resigning when their active affiliation with General Service Headquarters ceased.

Advance paid registrations to June 25, 1955, totalled 2,102.

The Committee noted with deep gratitude the special contributions of Herb Morse and Art Daley toward the development of dual-purpose displays documenting General Service Headquarters activities. The displays were designed for use at Kiel Auditorium following the close of the Conference. It also expressed, on behalf of the movement, A.A.'s gratitude to the guest speakers who have cooperated to make the Convention an outstanding event in A.A. history.

DIRECTORY LISTING OF DELEGATES IS REJECTED
PROPOSAL TO CHANGE RATIO OF TRUSTEES IS TABLED

(Proposal #10)

This proposal, that Delegates be listed in the A.A. World Directory, had originally been presented to Conference personnel in a special mailing in August of 1954 when plans for the '55 Directory got under way.

The mail poll was inconclusive, only 15 out of 76 Delegates reporting to Service Headquarters on reaction to the proposal in their areas.

When the proposal was again presented to Delegates at the 1955 Conference, it was instantly apparent that members had no desire to suggest, in the slightest way, that Delegates should be accorded special distinction or recognition in the Directory.

The vote to reject the proposal was unanimous.

The Chairman of the General Service Board presented for the consideration of the Conference a suggestion that the ratio between alcoholic and non-alcoholic Trustees of the Board be changed.

At the present time there are eight non-Alcoholic Trustees and seven who are alcoholics.

After considerable discussion, including a number of tributes to the non-alcoholic Trustees for the service to the movement, it was agreed that the subject should be tabled during the Fifth Conference.

It was further agreed that the subject will be placed on the agenda for the 1956 Conference.

NO PERMANENCY IN CONFERENCE FOR EX-TRUSTEES

(Proposal #11)

The proposal that Ex-Trustees of the General Service Board should be permanent members of the Conference, with the privilege of attending sessions at their own expense, brought into focus the feeling of the Delegates that the principles of rotation should be applied to all volunteer members of the Conference.

Several Delegates expressed appreciation of the service rendered by ex-Trustees but were firm in their belief that deviations from the application of rotation principles in Conference affairs would not be in the best interests of the movement.

The sentiment of the Conference was quickly apparent and the proposal was rejected unanimously with a minimum of discussion.

PROMULGATION OF ANONYMITY RESOLUTION APPROVED

As a result of several highly-publicized anonymity breaks in recent years, Bill in November, 1954, prepared for consideration of the movement a resolution setting forth the importance of the anonymity tradition and directing the General Service Board to take appropriate steps to inform all media of the Society's traditional position on the subject.

The proposal approving the resolution was adopted unanimously.

This action was then supplemented by a subsequent vote requesting that the resolution be publicized in the monthly General Service Bulletin to groups and that groups be supplied with a copy of the resolution for posting in meeting places.

Following these votes, several related questions were voiced by Delegates:

1. Did anonymity "at the public level" include books?
2. Did interpretation of the tradition of anonymity (and of other traditions) lie within the province of the Conference which might, from year to year, develop different interpretations?
3. What action might the Conference take in the future in cases where deliberate deviations from the tradition might be involved?

Asked to comment on these questions, Bill emphasized that both the Steps and the Traditions "obviously mean what each individual construes them to mean." Up to now, the founders and early members had been so-called "guardians" of the Traditions, Bill said, reminding the Conference that adoption of a permanent Third Legacy charter would transfer that responsibility to the Conference itself.

The proposed Conference charter makes it clear, he pointed out, that no agency in A.A. should ever have the right to coerce or punish or attempt to exercise authority over any individual, whatever his deviation from the Traditions may be.

It was pointed out by both Bill and Headquarters staff personnel that the number of violations of anonymity has shrunk encouragingly in recent years, that most deviations are not deliberate and that there is increasing public understanding of A.A.'s position.

DELEGATES VOTE TO DISCONTINUE CONFERENCE FUND

(Proposal #3)

The 1954 Conference had reviewed at length and then tabled a proposal that the special annual appeal for funds to underwrite the General Service Conference be discontinued. The '54 Delegates had also agreed that the proposal should be reconsidered in 1955.

Preliminary discussion prior to voting on the subject at this year's Conference disclosed general optimism concerning the movement's willingness to underwrite the Conference, if properly informed on its importance to A.A.'s world services. Discussion centered on two points:

1. The prevailing opinion that it would be desirable to reduce the frequency with which groups are importuned for financial support of both local and movement-wide service agencies.
2. The "practical consideration" that previous Conference optimism had not resulted in raising appreciably the per capita contributions to Headquarters services. A spokesman for this viewpoint suggested that the annual appeal from Headquarters for two dollars per year per member should be changed to three dollars per year per member.

After full discussion, the Conference voted overwhelmingly to discontinue the Conference Fund appeal. A number of Delegates expressed confidence that contributions to the General Service Headquarters Fund could be increased as a consequence of this action. In the event this does not occur, it was agreed that the question of a special appeal should be placed on the agenda for the 1956 Conference.

PERMANENT CHARTER FOR CONFERENCE ADOPTED

One of the most impressive moments in the five year history of the General Service Conference occurred Tuesday morning when, following full and mature consideration, the Delegates reflected the opinion of local A.A. areas throughout North America by adopting the proposed permanent "Charter of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous -- North American Section," subject to approval of the 20th Anniversary Convention of A.A.

Standing in silence for 30 seconds at the conclusion of thorough discussion, the Delegates invoked the guidance of the Higher Power who shall always be recognized as the only Authority in the movement.

Three specific questions were covered in the discussion prior to the vote: (In each case, Bill clarified the discussion).

1. He explained that New York Area (A.A.) Trustees are selected in a manner different from the process used to select other Trustees because of the importance of picking people who have background and training with the service agencies.
2. He pointed out that the Conference has the practical means of reorganizing the General Service Board, and its subsidiary service entities (by withholding financial support).
3. He explained that by-laws of the General Service Board determine the number of Trustees on the Board, making it both unnecessary and undesirable to "freeze" the number in the text of the Charter.

The full text of the Charter follows:

C H A R T E R

THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

(NORTH AMERICAN SECTION)

1. Purpose: The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the World Services and of the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous. The Conference shall be a service body only; never a government for Alcoholics Anonymous.

2. Composition: The Conference (North American Section) shall be composed of State and Provincial Delegates, the Trustees of the General Service Board, Directors and staff members of the New York Headquarters and such ex-Trustees or foreign Delegates as the Conference may wish to invite.

PERMANENT CHARTER FOR CONFERENCE ADOPTED
(Continued)

Other Sections of the Conference may sometime be created in foreign lands as the need arises out of language or geographical considerations. The North American Section of the General Service Conference will then become the Senior Section, related to the other Sections by ties of mutual consultation and a cross linking of Delegates.

But no Conference Section shall ever be placed in authority over another. All joint action shall be taken only upon two-thirds vote of the combined Sections. Within its boundaries each Conference ought to be autonomous. Only matters seriously affecting A.A.'s world-wide needs shall be the subject of joint consideration.

3. Conference Relation to A.A.: The Conference will act for A.A. in the perpetuation and guidance of its World Services, and it will also be the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its views upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition. Delegates should be free to vote as their conscience dictates; they should also be free to decide what questions should be taken to the group level, whether for information, discussion or their own direct instruction.

But no change in the A.A. Tradition itself may be made with less than the written consent of two-thirds of all the A.A. Groups.

4. Conference Relation to A.A. Headquarters: The Conference will replace the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous who formerly functioned as guides and advisors to The General Service Board and its related Headquarters services. The Conference will be expected to afford a reliable cross-section of A.A. opinion for this purpose.

To effectively further this same purpose it will be understood, as a matter of tradition, that a two-thirds vote of a Conference quorum shall be considered binding upon the General Service Board and its related corporate services. A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of all the Conference members registered.

But no such vote ought to impair the legal rights of the General Service Board and the service corporations to conduct routine business and make ordinary contracts relating thereto.

It will be further understood that, as a matter of tradition, a three quarters vote of all Conference members may bring about a reorganization of the General Service Board and the Headquarters, if or when such reorganization is deemed essential.

Under such a proceeding, the Conference may request resignations, may nominate new Trustees and may make all other necessary arrangements regardless of the legal prerogatives of the General Service Board.

PERMANENT CHARTER FOR CONFERENCE ADOPTED
(Continued)

5. State and Provincial Assemblies: Composition of: State and Provincial Assemblies are composed of the elected Representatives of all A.A. groups desiring to participate, in each of the United States and each of the Provinces of Canada.

Each State and Province will always be entitled to one Assembly. But States and Provinces of large A.A. populations will be entitled to additional Assemblies, as provided by this Manual of World Service, or by any future amendment thereto.

6. State and Provincial Assemblies: Purpose of: State and Provincial Assemblies convene every two years for the election of State and Provincial Committeemen, from which are selected Delegates to the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous held at New York. Such State or Provincial Assemblies are concerned only with the World Service affairs of Alcoholics Anonymous.

7. State and Provincial Assemblies: Method of Electing Committeemen and Delegates: Whenever practicable, Committeemen are elected by written ballot without personal nomination. And Delegates are selected from among such Committeemen by a two-thirds written ballot or by lot, as provided in the Manual of World Service.

8. State and Provincial Assemblies: Terms of Office For Group Representatives, Committeemen and Delegates: Unless otherwise directed by the Conference, these terms of office shall all be concurrent and of two years duration each. In half the States and Provinces, Assembly elections will be held in the even years; the remaining half of the Assemblies will elect in the odd years, thus creating rotating Panels One and Two of the Conference as further described in the Manual of World Service.

9. The General Service Conference Meetings: The Conference will meet yearly in the City of New York, unless otherwise agreed upon. Special meetings may be called should there be a grave emergency. The Conference may also render advisory opinions at any time by a mail or telephone poll in aid of the General Service Board or its related services.

10. The General Service Board: Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous shall be an incorporated Trusteeship composed of alcoholics and nonalcoholics who choose their own successors, these choices being subject, however, to the approval of the Conference or a committee thereof. Alcoholic out-of-town Trustees are, however, first nominated by their areas or by their State or Provincial Committees after being cleared by the Conference Nominating Committee.

They are then elected to the General Service Board, the Trustees being obligated by tradition so to do.

PERMANENT CHARTER FOR CONFERENCE ADOPTED
(Continued)

The General Service Board is the chief Service Arm of the Conference, and is essentially custodial in its character.

Excepting for decisions upon matters of policy, finance or A.A. Tradition, liable to seriously affect A.A. as a whole, the General Service Board has entire freedom of action in the routine conduct of the policy and business affairs of the A.A. General Headquarters at New York and may name suitable committees and elect directors to its subsidiary corporate service entities in pursuance of this purpose.

The General Service Board is primarily responsible for the financial , and policy integrity of its subsidiary services: A.A. Publishing, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and for such other service corporations as the Conference may desire to form.

The Charter and By Laws of the General Service Board, or any amendments thereto, should always be subject to the approval of the General Service Conference by a two-thirds vote of all its members.

Except in a great emergency, neither the General Service Board nor any of its related services ought ever take any action liable to greatly affect A.A. as a whole, without first consulting the Conference. It is nevertheless understood that the Board shall at all times reserve the right to decide which of its actions or decisions may require the approval of the Conference.

11. The General Service Conference: Its General Procedures: The Conference will hear the financial and policy reports of the General Service Board and its related Headquarters Services. The Conferences will advise with the Trustees, Directors and Staff members of the Headquarters upon all matters presented as affecting A.A. as a whole, engage in debate, appoint necessary committees and pass suitable resolutions for the advice or direction of the General Service Board and the Headquarters.

The Conference may also discuss and recommend appropriate action respecting serious deviations from A.A. Tradition or harmful misuse of the name, "Alcoholics Anonymous."

The Conference may draft any needed by-laws and will name its own officers and committees by any method of its own choosing.

The Conference at the close of each yearly session, will draft a full report of its proceedings to be supplied to all Delegates and Committeemen; also a condensation thereof which will be sent to A.A. Groups throughout the world.

PERMANENT CHARTER FOR CONFERENCE ADOPTED
(Continued)

12. General Warranties of the Conference: In all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition, taking great care that the Conference never becomes the seat of perilous wealth or power; that sufficient operating funds, plus an ample reserve, be its prudent financial principle; that none of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others; that all important decisions be reached by discussion vote and whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; that no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to serious public controversy; that though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in thought and action.

#

"AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING

Following the custom established in 1954, a special session was set aside exclusively for Area Delegates. Meeting in a two-hour closed session, their deliberations covered many topics later summarized in Committee Reports. Winton G. of South Florida was selected Chairman of next year's meeting.

#

PANEL AGREES G.S.R. PLAN CAN STRENGTHEN SERVICES

Delegates from Alberta, Sacramento Area in California, Kansas, Mississippi and the Pittsburgh (Penna.) Areas participated in an informative panel discussion on the first year's operations of the General Service Representative Plan.

In general it was agreed that a great deal remained to be done by Delegates and Area Committeemen in interpreting the significance of the Plan to the groups. The importance of having qualified people as General Service Representatives was emphasized. The need for continuing indoctrination, utilizing materials prepared at Service Headquarters, was also stressed.

One delegate noted the desirability of putting major cities in an A.A. area into separate districts for General Service representation purposes. Another conferee pointed out that topographical features, such as a mountain range in his area, often serve as the guide to effective organization of Area Committees in which the G.S.R. plays a key role.

A delegate reported an increase from eight to 52 in the number of groups (out of a total of 60) that have appointed Group representatives since the idea was first proposed in 1952.

It was pointed out that the use of Bulletins by Delegates to G.S.R.'s can be effective in increasing the latter's interest in the plan.

An Eastern Delegate, estimating that approximately 50 per cent of the groups in his area had appointed Representatives, said that many of the smaller groups had not yet adopted the plan. But even among these units, he said, there appeared to be increasing awareness of the importance of closer contact with Headquarters service agencies.

Several of the panelists indicated that their own sense of responsibility for helping to develop the plan had increased as they had become more familiar with the full implications of the total General Service Conference structure.

MORE HELP TO PRISON, HOSPITAL GROUPS URGED

Delegates from the District of Columbia, Indiana, Houston, Utah, and the State of Washington indicated that substantial progress is being made in making A.A. meaningful to members in prisons and hospitals.

Practical experience is demonstrating, they agreed, that local group activity can be productive in helping men and women in institutions to recover from alcoholism.

In one state alone, in a two-year period, it was reported, more than 700 hospitalized alcoholics have been helped through a statewide program directed by a Commission of which several A.A.s are members. A feature of this program is the emphasis on self-commitment of the alcoholic as a safeguard against loss of civil rights.

In another state, 301 persons were rehabilitated in a single year through a similar program, a panelist said.

One delegate told of the request of an inmate for the formation of a fellowship among A.A.s outside prison to help ex-convicts find a place in society, to establish sound relationships with prison authorities, to act as trusted counselors of the ex-inmate and to help broaden his view of A.A.'s way of life.

Another delegate warned that inmates can be over-indulged and stressed the importance of working closely with ex-inmates during the first ten days after they leave prison. "The main thing," he said, "is never to give up on a man."

In one area, as a result of a close relationship with court authorities, special meetings about A.A. are held regularly every Saturday morning for men and women on probation and others suggested by the court. Average attendance has been about 75 per meeting. In 1954, 185 alcoholics took part, of whom 164 are still sober. In nine years about 1,000 persons have been exposed to the program; less than five per cent are estimated to have been arrested following exposure to A.A. therapy.

It was the sense of the full session that Service Headquarters should consider the preparation of special literature designed for use in institutional programs.

NEW EDITION OF "BIG BOOK" RELEASED

Bill's eagerly-awaited up-dating of the first edition of the Big Book was unveiled to Conference members at the sixth session Tuesday night. In describing the background of this phase of his long-range writing project, Bill made the following points:

1. "Not an iota" of the first part of the text dealing with recovery principles had been changed.
2. The story section has been changed and enlarged to present a more accurate cross-section of A.A.'s membership today. When the first edition was prepared, the number of recovered alcoholics was about 100 and most of them were what we now describe as "low bottom" alcoholics. There was only one woman's story; no personal stories by young people or alcoholics who had not suffered heavily. The new edition contains 37 stories in three main categories.
3. Although the old foreword has been retained for sentimental reasons, a new foreword has been added to bridge the gap in the story of A.A.'s growth from 1939 to 1955. The new edition also includes material dealing with the Twelve Traditions for group survival, (unknown in 1939, of course), with religious and medical appraisals of A.A. and with the award of the Lasker Trophy in 1951.

Bill paid special tribute to Ed. B. and Nell W., his Research and Editorial assistants, who are sifting and organizing A.A. historical data for future writing projects and for the movement's archives.

Now under consideration is a special historical summary of A.A. to be based in large part on his three 1955 Convention talks on Recovery, Unity and Service, Bill indicated. This would not be a definitive history, he said, but would establish the framework for subsequent writings.

In establishing a price structure for the new book, the Delegates took into consideration the unique relation of the book to the movement, the increase in size and associated cost increases and the fact that publication this year was not assured when the Conference last year voted to discontinue discounts to the groups.

After careful and comprehensive analysis of all factors involved, the Delegates voted overwhelmingly to set the retail price of the new edition at \$4.50, the price to A.A. groups at \$4.00 and to earmark fifty cents for the Reserve Fund. To maintain uniformity in publishing practices, Delegates also voted to keep the retail price of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" at \$2.75, with the price to A.A. groups at \$2.50, and that twenty-five cents be earmarked for the Reserve Fund. In addition, the Delegates voted that this action, to the extent that it relates to the subject of discounts, be regarded as an amendment to the 1954 Conference action.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

Following the precedent established in 1953, every opportunity was given Delegates to permit them to raise any question pertaining to Service Headquarters operations and their relation to the Conference structure. A question box was available at all times and its contents read to the Conference at intervals. Some points were discussed by the full Conference, others were referred to committees or to the staff. The following summary indicates the disposition and the scope of questions raised during the four-day meeting.

<u>Question</u>	<u>Disposition</u>
1. Should A.A. accept offer of writer of an "A.A. song" to accept royalties on a proposed recording?	Agreed that a precedent would be established. Offer declined, as was done in case of book publisher last year.
2. When banquets have been held in connection with State meetings, have results been successful?	Four replies from floor indicated great variety of experience. No pattern.
3. Have French-speaking groups in Canada requested Big Book translation?	Text part is available in mimeographed form for \$1.00 in Montreal, Quebec.
4. To prevent exploitation, should Directory be sent only to Intergroups where they exist?	Agreed this was a matter of local autonomy.
5. What basis for reckoning expenses might be established as guide to local A.A. in determining size of bequests acceptable?	Chair re-stated A.A. custom of declining bequests, even from members. Informal suggestion made that member's contributions not exceed 1/10 of 1% of local office expenses each year while he is alive.
6. Could a new slide film on World Services of Headquarters be prepared?	Chair pointed out cost is prohibitive based on number of potential users.
7. Does Bill receive a salary? If so, how much?	Bill answered, pointed out that his sole income consists of royalties from his writings. This has fluctuated from year to year. Citing his recent earnings figures, Bill emphasized he was not concerned with receiving more than a modest income.
8. Can subscription blank be placed in <u>every</u> copy of The Grapevine?	Referred to Grapevine Committee.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

- | | |
|---|--|
| 9. What is the meaning of "Trade Customers" in Publishing Co. balance sheet? | Refers to A.A. groups in virtually all cases (and to limited number of other purchasers: Commissions, etc.) |
| 10. Is it possible to confuse complacency with serenity? | No comment |
| 11. Requested that Bill write special pamphlet, abbreviated, on routine & conduct of all elections at Area meetings. (G.S.C.) | Bill explained Areas are at liberty to "lift" any material they need from the Third Legacy Manual, and distribute locally. |
| 12. Can page 32 of "Manual" be expanded and made available free? | Literature Committee considering. |
| 13. Can "Manual" be mailed to all Area Committeemen? | Headquarters will handle. |
| 14. What can be done to prevent misuse of Directory by publishing companies offering literature to Groups? | Explained that Headquarters follows up all violations called to its attention, directing attention to confidential nature of the directory. It was suggested that A.A. members protest individually in writing when misuse of Directory comes to their attention. |
| 15. Is it good "procedure" for local Areas to distribute A.A. lapel emblems? Should Headquarters have an "overall" emblem? | (A) Problem of local autonomy. (B) Agreed not desirable to put Headquarters into emblem business. |
| 16. What is the general opinion of results obtained from radio and television programs on A.A? | Two Delegates reported successful programs. Agreed programs can be helpful. It was pointed out that Headquarters has background material for radio and television programs that has been used effectively by several hundred groups. (Members appear anonymously, of course.) |
| 17. Should number of non-A.A. Trustees be "frozen" at seven, with any increase in Board to be exclusively A.A? | Rising vote of gratitude to non-A.A. Trustees, followed by vote to put subject on 1956 Conference Agenda. |

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

- | | |
|--|--|
| 18. Is there a suggested plan for handling cases where Committeeman drinks or takes pills? | One Delegate reported on practice of having alternates available for "emergencies." Another Delegate said that in his Area a resignation had been requested. |
| 19. Should non-A.A. Trustees be rotated? | General sense of the Conference was that movement owed deep debt to non-A.A. Trustees and should encourage them to serve as at present. |
| 20. What is meant by "great crises or hazardous emergencies" that might threaten A.A. and for which we should be prepared? | Bill spoke to this point, reminding Delegates the movement had never yet faced a serious economic setback or depression in the U.S. and Canada, or a serious political or religious division within the movement (not unknown in other movements). |
| 21. Delegate requested expression of Conference opinion regarding State Commissions on Alcoholism and rehabilitation centers that employ both the A.A. program and A.A. members. | Delegates with background on subject offered to meet with writer of the question. (Bill re-stated Traditional A.A. position that members may be employed in such situations so long as they do not "trade" on the A.A. name or accept pay for Twelfth Step work, as such. Often, Bill said, A.A.'s are among the few in an Area who have specialized knowledge of alcoholism and they should not be penalized simply because they are A.A.'s.) |
| 22. Can Bulletins to Groups be simpler and shorter? | Referred to Headquarters staff. |
| 23. Would it be practical and cheaper to combine the functions of A.A. Publishing Inc. and The Grapevine? (Accounting functions only) | Headquarters CPA pointed out two operations "do not mesh well," and savings of manpower would be fractional. Management problems would be increased through dual supervision of same personnel. |

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS
(Continued)

24. Delegate has returned to Conference for second term. Is he in violation of tradition of rotation? Is a dangerous precedent established? Should this Conference take action to clarify the matter for the future? (The Delegate did not succeed himself).

After considerable discussion during which the values of the rotation principle were re-emphasized, the problem was referred to the Policy Committee. (See page 35)

25. Should groups of Puerto Rico be granted representation at the Conference in the future? They have offered to defray expenses of a Delegate, if admitted to participation.

During discussion on the floor the question was broadened to cover representation from all territories. By formal vote, the Delegates, after returning to home areas, agreed to advise General Service Headquarters not later than January 1, 1956, whether Groups in Puerto Rico, Alaska and Hawaii may send a Delegate to the 1956 Conference, if the expenses of the latter are defrayed locally. A proposal on this subject is to be sent out by General Service Headquarters.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The Committee recommends:

1. That the Conference abide by the specific recommendation in Section #7 of the Third Legacy Manual, whereby no Delegate succeed himself. However, it is further provided in Section #7 that in rare cases, when a fully qualified person is not available, a Delegate may be elected at a future date. Your Policy Committee feels that the responsibility for this decision lies entirely with the local area.
2. That the display board, "A.A. Growth" be photographed and a copy be distributed to each Delegate as soon after the Conference adjourns as possible.
3. That Delegates who are receiving duplications of Conference mailings from General Service Headquarters, notify the Conference Secretary if they wish this changed.
4. That only in-coming and retiring Delegates remain on the General Conference mailing list, thus enabling a Delegate to receive Conference mailings for a period of four years.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE CONFERENCE REPORT

Members of the Committee met and, by lot, selected a Chairman from among members attending the Conference for the second year.

Members of the Committee agreed to review the first draft of the Conference Report very carefully and to send suggestions and comments to the Conference Secretary before the deadline for the final report.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE AGENDA

The Agenda Committee recommends that the present Conference Agenda be retained.

The Committee wishes to go on record as expressing its deep appreciation to Lib S., Conference Secretary, for her capable service in helping to prepare the Agenda for this Conference.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON CONFERENCE-APPROVED LITERATURE

The Literature Committee recommends the following for consideration by the General Service Conference of 1955.

1. Consideration be given to expansion of Section IV of Third Legacy Manual in respect to duties of G.S.R. to which might be added final paragraph of Section VI of Third Legacy Manual.
2. The Literature Committee shall continue to be advised and consulted on any discontinuing of old literature or addition of new literature.
3. Wherever possible upward revision in price of literature be avoided. With inevitable increasing costs A.A. Publishing be requested to investigate economies in purchase of paper, binding, printing, etc.
4. Consider publication of introductory A.A. pamphlet available to groups at not more than five cents, containing condensed extracts from "44 Questions" and "This is A.A.".
5. A.A. Publishing review literature sale for past year to determine if any unprofitable item should be discontinued.
6. The Literature Committee recommends that the literature order blank be revised for ordering purposes, in the following manner:

Alcoholics Anonymous (The Big Book)
The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions
This is A.A.
A.A. - 44 Questions and Answers
Young People and A.A.
A.A. for the Woman
A.A. Traditions
Sponsorship
Alcoholism the Illness
The Alcoholic Husband
The Alcoholic Wife
The Alcoholic Employee
A.A. and the Medical Profession
Sedatives and the Alcoholic
Saturday Evening Post Reprint
Fortune Reprint - A.A.
Good Housekeeping Reprint

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

Although traditionally there are no dues or fees in A.A. since one cannot pay for membership or a way of life, it is suggested that more emphasis should be placed on our coming of age, on our responsibilities as A.A. citizens, on our gratitude to our services, and our desire to see to it that A.A.'s message can always be carried to the alcoholic who does not know, no matter where he may be.

It is further suggested that each Delegate either through his Committeemen or personally, make an effort to reach the General Service Representative of each group so that the General Service Representative may personally follow through at the group level and individually, in making more members aware of these responsibilities.

In addition, since there is no longer a Conference Fund, this decision having been reached by the Delegates to this Conference, and since the Conference will be supported from over-all Group Funds in the future, it is further necessary that group contributions be increased. Therefore, it is suggested that over and above the customary group contributions which are based on the yardstick of \$2 per year per member, those Delegates who care to, might also put into circulation in their areas the Birthday Plan which has been successful in Oklahoma. Additional suggested plans for increasing contributions consist of the following:

1. Earmarking specific meetings for Headquarters contributions.
2. Piggy banks possibly in the form of empty whiskey bottles with the notation "Pour it in, Don't pour it out" or "Are you a piggy backer or piggy banker?"
3. Take a percentage of each group meeting collection for group contributions
4. Remind each member that 4¢ a week is more than \$2 per year.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS TO THE CONFERENCE

Since a third Delegate from Central Michigan was established in the original Third Legacy pamphlet plan, it is recommended that the request from the two present Michigan Delegates for a third Delegate be approved.

The Committee recommends that the Nevada representation be recognized as having begun with the 1955 General Service Conference. (Panel One.)

(Formal acceptance of this report was on a motion made by Stan W. of California, seconded by Ed P. of Toledo, and carried unanimously.)

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The following plan for selecting Class B Trustees from outlying areas is submitted for consideration, subject to approval of the General Service Conference:

- a) Canada should always fill one of these positions, the selection rotating from Province to Province.
- b) The United States should be divided into geographical sections as follows, Area A, Area B, Area C, Area D and Area E.

Area A should consist of:

Maine	Rhode Island	Delaware
New Hampshire	Massachusetts	Maryland
Vermont	Pennsylvania	Virginia
		Washington, D.C.

Area B should consist of:

Washington	Montana	North Dakota
Oregon	Minnesota	South Dakota
Idaho	Wyoming	Nebraska

Area C should consist of:

North Carolina	Louisiana	Alabama
Tennessee	Florida	Georgia
Arkansas	Mississippi	South Carolina
		Texas

Area D should consist of:

California	Colorado	Kansas
Nevada	Arizona	Oklahoma
Utah	New Mexico	

Area E should consist of:

Iowa	Illinois	Ohio
Wisconsin	Missouri	West Virginia
Michigan	Indiana	Kentucky

- c) Selection of Trustee from outlying areas should be rotated in succession from one geographical section to another.
- d) Assembly Area in the geographical sections should be determined by the largest A.A. population, the selection moving in the second round to the place with the next highest A.A. population.
- e) The Nominating Committee should notify the state or area General Service Conference Committee when there is a vacancy for a Class B Trustee from their area and ask the Committee to send in a name of a member to the Nominating Committee. It might be suggested to the State or Area Committee that it use the Third Legacy pamphlet method of selecting a Delegate to select a Class B. Trustee.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

Seven out of ten groups do not get the Grapevine. We suggest that the Grapevine send out sample free copies of the issue carrying Convention news (August) to the groups that do not take bulk orders, the copies to be accompanied by a covering letter to this effect: "This is your Grapevine. We know that you will be interested in news of the recent Convention held in St. Louis. According to our records your group does not take the Grapevine. If all your members already subscribe as individuals then perhaps you could pass these copies along to a new member or to a hospital or prison group in your area".

Due to the cost involved the Grapevine does not include in each issue a subscription form. We personally are going to insert order blanks in those issues when we receive them at our group and might recommend that others do this.

The Committee believes that full advantage is not being taken of the special articles contained in the Grapevine, written to encourage discussion. If the Chairman of a discussion group has a copy of the Grapevine on hand and refers to it during the discussion the members may become interested in purchasing or subscribing.

The purpose of all A.A. literature is to carry the message. One very effective way is a gift subscription for new members, hospital or prison groups.

The Grapevine can only grow in accordance with the A.A. Tradition of attraction. Seven out of ten groups do not now receive the Grapevine. Conference delegates can assist in this form of 12th Step work by telling each area about the Grapevine.

There was a gratifying rise in the circulation of the Grapevine immediately following the 1954 Conference. A major factor in this increase was the appointment of a Grapevine Representative at the group level. The 1955 Committee heartily endorses this method of getting the Grapevine into the hands of members.

The Committee in caucus suggests that the Grapevine Committee could be extended to include all delegates present. You're all nominated as Circulation Managers of the Grapevine for your area. The title is not official.

NOTE ON COMMITTEE SELECTION PROCEDURE

All Committees of the 1955 Conference, as of all previous Conferences, were, selected by lot, the Committees being equally divided between first- and second-year men. Chairmen of the 1955 Committees were chosen by the Committee membership.

I N D E X T O A P P E N D I C E S

Appendix I	Conference Agenda	41
Appendix II	Financial Statements	42
Appendix III	Roster of Delegates	51
Appendix IV	Trustees and Headquarters Staff	53
Appendix V	Contributions to General Service Headquarters . .	54
Appendix VI	Contributions to Conference Fund	56
Appendix VII	A.A. Grapevine Circulation Analysis	58
Appendix VIII	Committees of the Conference	59

DIGEST OF AGENDA OF FIFTH ANNUAL GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE * 1955

SUNDAY, JUNE 26

- Evening -- Registration of Delegates
 Dinner for Delegates and Spouses
 Greetings from Bill
 Introduction of Headquarters and Grapevine Personnel
-

MONDAY, JUNE 27

- Morning -- First Session - Reports on Year's Services
 Selection of Committees
- Afternoon -- Second Session - Consideration of Policy Proposals
- Evening -- Third Session (For Area Delegates Only)
-

TUESDAY, JUNE 28

- Morning -- Fourth Session - The Conference Charter
- Afternoon -- Fifth Session - Panel Discussions ("G.S.R. Plan" and "Prison
 & Hospital Sponsorship Programs")
- Evening -- Sixth Session - Bill's Report on Writing Project
-

WEDNESDAY, JUNE 29

- Morning -- Seventh Session - Discussion of matters referred from
 "Delegates Only" meeting and of other questions
- Afternoon -- Eighth Session - Reports and Recommendations of Conference
 Committees
 Talks by Bernard B. Smith (Chairman) and Bill W.
-

SUNDAY, JULY 3

- Afternoon -- Ninth and Final Session at Kiel Auditorium
 (Session conducted as part of closing session of 20th
 Anniversary Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous)
- Reports and Recommendations of Conference Committees
 Talks by Bernard B. Smith (Chairman) and Bill W.
-

 FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

It is one of the purposes of the General Service Conference to bring to the A.A. movement a wider knowledge of the functioning of the General Service Headquarters. Complete details of the financial aspects of the Headquarters are presented in the attached financial statements, which have been prepared by our independent certified public accountant from his reports.

A brief explanation of the corporate structure is necessary for a proper understanding of these statements. A.A. PUBLISHING, INC. is a stock corporation whose functions are the publication of Conference-approved literature and the operation of the Headquarters office. THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC. is a stock corporation which publishes our monthly magazine.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A., INC. (formerly the Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.) owns all of the capital stock of A.A. PUBLISHING, INC. and the full beneficial interest in the net assets and income of THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC. The assets of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A., INC. are segregated into four separate funds, as follows:

- (1) GENERAL FUND, which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.
- (2) GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which may be used solely for paying the expenses of the General Service Headquarters office.
- (3) CONFERENCE FUND, which may be used solely for paying the expenses of the General Service Conference.
- (4) RESERVE FUND, to accumulate a prudent reserve for future contingencies.

Following is an index to the attached financial statements:

ALL CORPORATIONS	Combined Summary of Income and Accumulated Income	Exhibit A
THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A., INC.	Balance Sheet Principal of Funds Income Statement	Exhibit B Exhibit C Exhibit D
A.A. PUBLISHING, INC.	Balance Sheet Income Statement	Exhibit E Exhibit F
THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.	Balance Sheet Income Statement	Exhibit G Exhibit H

COMBINED SUMMARY OF OPERATIONS AND ACCUMULATED INCOME
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953
GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF AA, INC., A.A. PUBLISHING, INC., A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

	1954	1953
<u>THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A., INC.</u>		
<u>GENERAL FUND - Exhibit D</u>		
Costs of Trustees' Meetings, foreign and other pamphlets, rent and other expenses	\$ 13,949	\$ 9,919
less interest on savings accounts	<u>None</u>	<u>2,007</u>
Net Expense	\$ 13,949	\$ 7,912
<u>GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS</u>		
Salaries, rent, stationery, postage, printing, telephone, taxes, etc. - Exhibit F	157,013	140,053
Less A.A. Publishing, Inc., share	<u>38,238</u>	<u>27,190</u>
Net Expenses	118,775	112,863
<u>GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE</u>		
Travel, hotels, meals, meetings, reports, salary, etc. - Exhibit D	18,899	19,832
Less Conference Fund revenue	<u>9,718</u>	<u>11,157</u>
Net Expense	<u>9,181</u>	<u>8,675</u>
<u>Net Cost of Services</u>	141,905	129,450
<u>Group Contributions</u>	<u>117,190</u>	<u>113,057</u>
<u>Excess of Cost</u>	(24,715)	(16,393)
<u>A.A. PUBLISHING, INC. - Exhibit F</u>		
Cost of producing materials sold	68,319	83,724
Share of G.S.H. expenses (above)	38,238	27,190
Editing, research, legal accounting		
Bedford Hills expense, etc.	<u>14,942</u>	<u>12,277</u>
	<u>121,499</u>	<u>123,191</u>
Sales of books, pamphlets, etc.	<u>140,329</u>	<u>182,271</u>
Excess of Income	18,830	59,080
<u>A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC. - Exhibit H</u>		
Printing and mailing	42,349	39,073
Salaries, rent, telephone, postage, taxes and other expenses	<u>40,041</u>	<u>36,484</u>
	<u>82,390</u>	<u>75,557</u>
Subscriptions, sales and interest	<u>87,232</u>	<u>80,540</u>
Excess of Income	<u>4,841</u>	<u>4,983</u>
COMBINED NET INCOME (EXPENSE)	(1,044)	47,670
RESERVE FUND INCOME - Exhibit D	13,932	None
ACCUMULATED INCOME		
Balance, January 1	204,538	156,868
Balance, December 31	<u>217,426</u>	<u>204,538</u>

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

	1954	1953
ASSETS		
GENERAL FUND	\$66,070.71	\$162,073.65
Cash in commercial accounts	\$31,131.11	\$42,107.38
Cash in savings accounts		84,700.27
Prepaid expense	778.60	1,105.00
Advances to Group Contrib.Fund	20,000.00	20,000.00
Investment in A.A. Publishing, Inc.	500.00	500.00
Investment in and advances to The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	<u>13,661.00</u>	<u>13,661.00</u>
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND	22,175.55	26,488.89
Cash in bank	22,138.05	26,451.39
U. S. Savings Bonds (at cost)	<u>37.50</u>	<u>37.50</u>
CONFERENCE FUND	914.31	2,408.31
Cash in bank	696.35	1,975.59
Due from A.A. Publishing, Inc.		5.00
Due from Group Contrib.Fund	127.50	285.50
Prepaid expense - subsequent Conference	<u>90.46</u>	<u>142.22</u>
RESERVE FUND	108,632.74	
Cash in savings accounts	106,925.24	
Due from A.A. Publishing, Inc.	<u>1,707.50</u>	
Total Assets	<u>197,793.31</u>	<u>190,970.85</u>
LIABILITIES		
GENERAL FUND	\$ 1,551.41	\$ 600.00
Accounts payable	\$ 1,522.69	\$ 500.00
Due A.A. Publishing, Inc.	<u>28.72</u>	<u>100.00</u>
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND	33,282.44	36,010.51
Due General Fund	20,000.00	20,000.00
Due Conference Fund	127.50	285.50
Due A.A. Publishing, Inc.	<u>13,154.94</u>	<u>15,725.01</u>
CONFERENCE FUND		
Deferred income, subsequent Conference	<u>914.31</u>	<u>1,532.79</u>
Total Liabilities	35,748.16	38,143.30
PRINCIPAL OF FUNDS (Exhibit C)		
GENERAL FUND	64,519.30	161,473.65
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND (deficit)	(11,106.89)	(9,521.62)
CONFERENCE FUND	None	875.52
RESERVE FUND	<u>108,632.74</u>	
Total Principal	<u>162,045.15</u>	<u>152,827.55</u>
Total Liabilities and Principal	<u>197,793.31</u>	<u>190,970.85</u>

(Parentheses denote red figures)

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
STATEMENT OF PRINCIPAL OF FUNDS
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

	<u>1954</u>	<u>1953</u>
GENERAL FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$ 161,473.65	\$ 128,006.69
Excess of Income (Expense) for year (Exhibit D)	(2,254.08)	33,466.96
	<u>159,219.57</u>	<u>161,473.65</u>
Less: Transfer to Reserve Fund (below)	<u>94,700.27</u>	
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u>64,519.30</u>	<u>161,473.65</u>
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND		
Balance, January 1 (deficit)	(\$9,521.62)	(\$ 9,715.29)
Excess of Income (Expense) for year (Exhibit D)	(1,585.27)	193.67
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u>(11,106.89)</u>	<u>(9,521.62)</u>
CONFERENCE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$ 875.52	\$.929.23
Excess of Income (Expense) for year (Exhibit D)	(875.52)	(53.71)
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u>None</u>	<u>875.52</u>
RESERVE FUND		
Income for year (Exhibit D)	\$ 13,932.47	
Transfer from General Fund (above)	<u>94,700.27</u>	
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit B)	<u>108,632.74</u>	

(Parentheses denote red figures)

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
STATEMENT OF INCOME AND EXPENSE
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

	<u>1954</u>	<u>1953</u>
GENERAL FUND		
Dividends, A.A. Publishing, Inc.	\$20,000.00	\$ 50,000.00
Interest on Savings Accounts		<u>2,007.57</u>
Total Income	\$ 20,000.00	\$ 52,007.57
Rent	1,200.00	1,200.00
Trustees' Meetings	3,443.64	3,224.41
Foreign language pamphlets	3,166.95	2,775.84
Other pamphlets	1,967.38	
Grant to Conference Fund	8,305.12	8,621.24
Honorarium	2,000.00	1,500.00
Legal Accounting and other	<u>2,170.99</u>	<u>1,219.12</u>
Total Expense	22,254.08	18,540.61
Excess of Income (Expense) (Exhibit C)	<u>(2,254.08)</u>	<u>33,466.96</u>
GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND		
Contributions received	\$117,190.09	\$113,056.86
Share of costs of General Service		
Office (Exhibit F)	<u>118,775.36</u>	<u>112,863.19</u>
Excess of Income (Expense) (Exhibit C)	<u>(1,585.27)</u>	<u>193.67</u>
CONFERENCE FUND		
Subscriptions from Groups	\$ 9,383.38	\$ 8,648.17
Costs of resale material transferred to A.A. Publishing, Inc.	335.25	2,508.67
Grant from General Fund	<u>8,305.12</u>	<u>8,621.24</u>
Total Income	18,023.75	19,778.08
Delegates' travel in excess of \$100	4,205.78	3,841.64
Hotels, meals, meetings	10,621.89	9,542.60
Supplies, exhibits, postage etc.	964.48	1,126.73
Conference Report & Highlights	1,907.12	1,643.66
Recording & presentation charts		2,477.16
Secretarial salary	<u>1,200.00</u>	<u>1,200.00</u>
Total Expense	18,899.27	19,831.79
Excess of Income (Expense) (Exhibit C)	<u>(875.52)</u>	<u>(53.71)</u>
RESERVE FUND		
Donation of discounts formerly granted by A.A. Publishing, Inc. on sale of books:		
Alcoholics Anonymous	\$ 7,532.00	
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions	<u>1,649.00</u>	\$ 9,181.00
Gift of 1954 Texas State Conference		2,343.35
Interest on Savings Accounts		<u>2,408.12</u>
Total Income (Exhibit C)	<u>13,932.47</u>	
(Parentheses denote red figures)		

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

<u>ASSETS</u>	<u>1954</u>	<u>1953</u>
Cash on hand and in bank	\$ 23,222.69	\$ 19,865.83
Accounts Receivable	18,549.74	24,503.35
Trade Customers (after reserves of \$500 in 1954 and \$800 in 1953)	\$ 5,366.08	\$ 7,456.14
The General Service Board of A.A. Inc.	13,183.66	15,947.21
Other		<u>1,100.00</u>
Inventories	33,100.00	35,478.38
Prepaid expenses	1,789.27	416.67
Book plates, equipment, copyrights and goodwill	<u>1.00</u>	<u>1.00</u>
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>76,662.70</u>	<u>80,265.23</u>
<u>LIABILITIES</u>		
Accounts payable	\$ 5,043.39	4,768.89
Due The General Service Board of A.A., Inc.	1,707.50	127.20
Accrued royalties		4,230.91
Accrued taxes	<u>384.86</u>	<u>440.83</u>
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	\$ <u>7,135.75</u>	\$ <u>9,567.83</u>
<u>CAPITAL</u>		
Capital Stock		
Authorized 1,000 shares \$25 par value		
Outstanding 20 shares	500.00	500.00
Accumulated Earnings		
Balance, January 1	70,197.40	61,117.07
Net Income for Year (Exhibit F)	<u>18,829.55</u>	<u>59,080.33</u>
	89,026.95	120,197.40
Less: Dividends paid	<u>20,000.00</u>	<u>50,000.00</u>
Balance, December 31	<u>69,026.95</u>	<u>70,197.40</u>
<u>Total Capital</u>	<u>69,526.95</u>	<u>70,697.40</u>
<u>Total Liabilities and Capital</u>	<u>76,662.70</u>	<u>80,265.23</u>

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
INCOME STATEMENT
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

	<u>1954</u>		<u>1953</u>	
NET SALES				
Books	\$75,638.69		\$119,041.75	
Pamphlets	56,530.26		53,778.79	
Records	880.		1,861.	
Other products	<u>7,280.37</u>	\$140,329.32	<u>7,589.16</u>	\$182,270.70
COST OF SALES				
Books	16,498.94		21,754.74	
Pamphlets	24,582.40		24,466.71	
Records	1,500.		920.15	
Other products	2,364.16		4,230.21	
Packing supplies	2,159.53		1,861.46	
Writing fees	5,767.50		7,000.	
Royalties	<u>15,446.73</u>	<u>68,319.26</u>	<u>23,490.29</u>	<u>83,723.56</u>
GROSS PROFIT FROM SALES		72,010.06		98,547.14
OPERATING EXPENSES				
Office Expenses:				
Salaries	92,449.91		76,756.19	
Postage and express	9,875.06		12,783.23	
Stationery and supplies	4,749.98		4,025.39	
Rent and electricity	17,193.39		14,602.30	
Telephone and telegraph	2,422.98		2,215.49	
Payroll taxes and insurance	2,722.43		3,318.10	
Service Office printing	14,103.05		11,201.44	
Office equipment	6,208.56		5,984.19	
Other office expenses	<u>7,288.12</u>		<u>9,166.91</u>	
Total Office Expenses	<u>157,013.48</u>		<u>140,053.24</u>	
Less: Portion payable by the GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A. INC.	<u>118,775.36</u>	38,238.12	<u>112,863.19</u>	27,190.05
Other Expenses:				
Entertainment	211.20		469.11	
Travel	536.17		556.48	
Bedford Hills expense	3,980.00		3,752.95	
Accounting and legal	2,211.10		3,402.03	
Taxes, other than payroll	432.78		309.86	
Editing and research	6,767.30		3,309.07	
Loss on doubtful accounts	478.08		238.12	
Books donated to Great Britain Book Publishing Committee	<u>325.76</u>	<u>14,942.39</u>	<u>239.14</u>	<u>12,276.76</u>
Total Operating Expenses		<u>53,180.51</u>		<u>39,466.81</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit E)		<u>18,829.55</u>		<u>59,080.33</u>

THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

	<u>1954</u>		<u>1953</u>
<u>ASSETS</u>			
CASH		\$ 27,221.72	\$ 21,930.86
Commercial account	\$ 16,802.91		\$ 15,721.09
Savings account	10,318.81		6,109.77
Petty Cash fund	<u>100.00</u>		<u>100.00</u>
ACCOUNTS RECEIVABLE		1,887.46	1,411.19
DEFERRED CHARGES		6,680.40	5,847.79
Mailing and office supplies on hand	2,288.92		2,384.98
Prepaid rent & insurance	617.49		300.00
Printing and mailing January issue	<u>3,773.99</u>		<u>3,162.81</u>
FIXED ASSETS		3,482.82	3,100.19
Furniture and equipment	7,134.51		6,159.53
Less: Accumulated Depreciation	<u>3,651.69</u>		<u>3,059.34</u>
<u>TOTAL ASSETS</u>		<u>39,272.40</u>	<u>32,290.03</u>
<u>LIABILITIES AND CAPITAL</u>			
ACCOUNTS AND ACCRUALS PAYABLE		\$ 4,116.78	\$ 3,471.82
Accounts payable and advance payments	\$ 4,014.65		\$ 3,368.29
Accrued taxes	<u>102.13</u>		<u>103.53</u>
ADVANCED BY THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A., INC.		13,660.00	13,660.00
UNEARNED SUBSCRIPTION INCOME		<u>35,640.70</u>	<u>34,144.76</u>
<u>TOTAL LIABILITIES</u>		<u>53,417.48</u>	<u>51,276.58</u>
<u>CAPITAL AND DEFICIT</u>			
Capital stock - no par value			
Authorized, issued and outstanding			
3 shs Class A, 3 shs Class B		1.00	1.00
Deficit from operations		(14,146.08)	(18,987.55)
Balance January 1	(18,987.55)		(23,970.43)
Net Income for Period (Exhibit H)	<u>4,841.47</u>		<u>4,982.88</u>
<u>DEFICIT IN CAPITAL</u>		<u>(14,145.08)</u>	<u>(18,986.55)</u>
LIABILITIES LESS DEFICIT		<u>39,272.40</u>	<u>32,290.03</u>

(Parentheses denote red figures)

THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
INCOME STATEMENT
TWELVE MONTHS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1954 AND 1953

	<u>1954</u>	<u>1953</u>
<u>INCOME</u>		
Unearned income, January 1	\$34,144.76	\$33,060.58
Add: Subscriptions received	<u>52,947.69</u>	<u>51,995.24</u>
	87,092.45	85,055.82
Less: Portion applicable to subsequent issues	<u>35,640.70</u>	<u>34,144.76</u>
Income from subscriptions	\$51,451.75	\$50,911.06
Other sales	35,571.21	29,540.82
Interest on savings account	<u>209.04</u>	<u>88.52</u>
<u>TOTAL INCOME</u>	87,232.	80,540.40
<u>EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS</u>	53,526.66	49,460.49
Salaries	8,560.00	7,813.42
Printing	33,300.01	31,271.95
Mailing	9,048.81	7,801.00
Rent and telephone	1,435.58	1,499.87
Depreciation	84.15	74.76
Other Costs	<u>1,098.11</u>	<u>999.49</u>
<u>CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS EXPENSES</u>	28,863.87	26,097.03
Salaries	15,849.61	15,280.46
Office supplies and expense	3,249.24	1,468.69
Rent and telephone	1,853.71	1,772.64
Postage and miscellaneous	2,612.34	2,013.64
Accounting	1,000.00	900.00
Taxes	1,450.57	1,196.56
Promotion	2,340.20	2,582.82
Depreciation	<u>508.20</u>	<u>882.22</u>
<u>TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES</u>	82,390.53	75,557.52
<u>NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (EXHIBIT G)</u>	<u>4,841.47</u>	<u>4,982.88</u>

NOTE: The A.A. Grapevine Inc. operates on a fiscal year ending March 31. The above figures have been compiled from quarterly reports prepared for the management.

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
ROSTER OF DELEGATES
1955

-
- * Andersen, Chris, 318 Bay 13th Street, Brooklyn, New York
 - Boyles, B. E., 3490 Woods Avenue, Lincoln, Nebraska
 - * Brown, Charlie, 414 Crown Building, 615 West Pender St., Vancouver, B.C., Canada
 - Buchanan, Arthur W., 116 North Grove Street, East Aurora, New York
 - Burwell, James M., 4193 Georgia Street, San Diego 3, California
 - Caldwell, Maurice Hilliard, 181 Waterman Street, Providence 6, Rhode Island
 - Cardona, Tom, Box 788, Medford, Oregon
 - * Caron, Richard J., 19 Wyomissing Hills Boulevard, West Lawn, Pennsylvania
 - * Cassady, Burt J., Jr., 2037 Dartmouth Place, Charlotte 7, North Carolina
 - * Chancey, Bryan, 521 Massey Building, Birmingham, Alabama
 - Crosland, E. H., 2726 Blossom Street, Columbia, South Carolina
 - Davis, Harold P., North Shore Road, RFD #2, Derry, New Hampshire
 - * Delaney, Frank J., 1217 Windsor Avenue, Windsor, Connecticut
 - DeWeese, Pete, c/o A. DeWeese Lumber Company, Philadelphia, Mississippi
 - * Falloon, James H., 4205 Russell Avenue, Mt. Rainier, Maryland
 - * Fergeman, George, 1603 West 4th Street, Waterloo, Iowa
 - * Fors, Carl A., Box 805, Lansing, Michigan
 - Gilhuly, Ian K., Minnedosa, Manitoba, Canada
 - Goode, Leon, 1601 Magnolia Avenue, Knoxville, Tennessee
 - Grady, Maurice W., 1601 Bradley Street, Schenectady, New York
 - * Green, Winton, 910 Bruce Street, Tampa, Florida
 - * Gross, Maurice, 203 South Forrest Street, Forrest City, Arkansas
 - Haben, Wendell R., 1618 - 3rd Avenue, East, Hibbing, Minnesota
 - ** Hahn, A. J., 335 East A, Casper, Wyoming
 - * Hall, Clayton, 103 Ballard Avenue, Syracuse, New York
 - Henry, Edward, 349 Garden Avenue, Camden, New Jersey
 - * Henry, Jack, Box 1205, Fort Worth, Texas
 - * Hillmer, B. Whit, 217 Essex Street, Sarnia, Ontario, Canada
 - Holton, Frank, Frankford, Delaware
 - Jamieson, H. S., Moosomin, Saskatchewan, Canada
 - * Johnson, Gordon, 201 East Vanderbilt, Orlando, Florida
 - * Johnson, Howard S., 1012 Adams Street, Richland, Washington
 - * Joy, William C., Box 416, Flat Rock, Michigan
 - * Judd, Maurice W., Apt. 210, 127 Locust Street, Evansville, Indiana
 - Kavanagh, John, 322 East River Street, Dixon, Illinois
 - Kearney, Stan, 1335 Bernard Avenue, West Montreal, Quebec, Canada
 - Kelly, Charles B., Box 55, Aberdeen, South Dakota
 - * Kelly, E. P., 4020 West Silver Springs Drive, Milwaukee 9, Wisconsin
 - Lamb, Gilbert, Box 846, Muleshoe, Texas
 - Layne, Frank H., 13 First Avenue, Prestonburg, Kentucky
 - * New Delegate (Panel 5)
 - ** Alternate Delegate (Panel 4)

ROSTER OF DELEGATES (Continued)

-
- * Lowe, Thomas, Box 1068, Logan, West Virginia
 - Maloney, Victor G., 2910 Calderwood Lane, Sacramento 21, California
 - * Manzi, Nancy, 81 Constitution Avenue, Worcester, Massachusetts
 - Marcy, Henry, 106 Alleghany Avenue, Baltimore 4, Maryland
 - * Marineau, Al, 3643 Lankershim Boulevard, Los Angeles 28, California
 - Matheson, George, 4016 No. Keystone, Chicago, Illinois

 - Moncrief, A. E., 608 Pecan Street, Albany, Georgia
 - Neufeld, Arnold, 235 Grover Street, Antigo, Wisconsin
 - * Null, Larry, 1201 Barnard Drive, Las Vegas, Nevada
 - O'Neil, Cy, Box 682, Cut Bank, Montana
 - * O'Toole, Peter J., 17 Elwood Place, Newark, New Jersey

 - Perry, Walter, Colchester, Vermont
 - Phelps, Ira P., Box 1581, Corpus Christi, Texas
 - * Poe, Lane, 904 East Drive, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma
 - ** Pratt, Edward, 2614 $\frac{1}{2}$ Broadway, Apt. 5, Toledo, Ohio
 - Pratt, Lee, Box 1444, Fargo, North Dakota

 - Reddoch, Charles, Box 1573, Boise, Idaho
 - * Reese, Clifford D., Lakeview, Provo, Utah
 - * Robinson, Thomas W., 14 Vernon Terrace, Alexandria, Virginia
 - Russell, John, Route #1, Great Bend, Kansas

 - * Sawyer, Bob, 1508 Craig, Galena Park, Texas
 - Schwarz, Mary Lu, 3102 Monroe, N.E., Albuquerque, New Mexico
 - * Shaffer, Ray, 1030 Orange Street, Coshocton, Ohio
 - Shrubsall, A. J., 318 - 10th Street, N.W., Calgary, Alberta, Canada
 - Smith, James A., 40 Brookline Avenue, Springfield, Massachusetts

 - * Tonies, Gerard B., 454 North 24th Street, East St. Louis, Illinois
 - * Veigle, Charles J., Bethlehem Steel Company, Johnstown, Pennsylvania
 - Wallace, Bruce, Box 102, Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada
 - * Warner, Jim, Box 495, Shreveport, Louisiana
 - Welch, Arthur D., 22 Monument Square, Portland, Maine

 - * Werntz, Orville F., Warrensburg, Missouri ✓
 - Whitehead, Bert, Box 3236, Lowell, Arizona
 - * Whittier, Glenn, Box 1255, Sterling, Colorado
 - * Wilsey, Stan, 869 Guerrero Street, San Francisco 10, California
 - * Woods, Ferris, 394 North Cleveland Avenue, St. Paul, Minnesota

 - * New Delegate (Panel 5)
 - ** Alternate Delegate (Panel 4)

1955 CONFERENCE MEMBERS
(Trustees & Headquarters)

TRUSTEES

NON-ALCOHOLIC

Mr. Jack Alexander
919 Montgomery Avenue
Bryn Mawr, Pennsylvania

Mr. Frank B. Amos
24 Smallwood Place
North White Plains, N.Y.

Mr. Frank Gulden
50 Elizabeth Street
New York 13, N.Y.

Mr. Leonard V. Harrison, Vice-Chairman
105 East 22nd Street
New York 10, N.Y.

Dr. John L. Norris
Medical Department
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, N.Y.

Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer
200 East 66th Street
New York, N.Y.

Mr. Bernard B. Smith, Chairman
460 Park Avenue
New York 22, N.Y.

TRUSTEE EMERITUS

Mr. A. LeRoy Chipman
Midston House
22 East 38th Street
New York, N.Y.

GENERAL SERVICE
HEADQUARTERS STAFF

Henry F. Grieme
Marian Fiske
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Hazel Rice
Lib Symington

A.A. GRAPEVINE STAFF

Louise Shonts
Katharine Swentzel
Sarah Thompson

ALCOHOLIC

Adam T. Capeling
761 Bayview Avenue
Toronto, Ontario, Canada

J. Seegar Heavilin
48 Beech Street
Cedar Grove, New Jersey

Cal J. McCarthy, Jr., Secretary
125 East 84th Street
New York 28, N.Y.

Sigurd P. Sandmore
180 Lyons Road
Scarsdale, New York

E. D. Sheridan
4569 Lorraine
Dallas, Texas

Clifford A. Walker, Vice-Chairman
1163 Ocean View
Whittier, California

Henry J. Zoeller
87-10 Clover Hill Road
Hollis 23, L.I., New York

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Sidney Allen, Secretary-Treasurer
Don Goddard, Chairman-Editor
J. Seegar Heavilin
Tom O'Brien, Jr.
Sigurd P. Sandmore

A.A. PUBLISHING DIRECTORS

Marian Fiske, Secretary
Henry F. Grieme, Chairman
Leonard V. Harrison, 1st Vice-Chmn.
Cal J. McCarthy, Jr., 2nd Vice-Chmn.
Herbert A. Morse, Treasurer
Sigurd P. Sandmore

GRAPEVINE AND HEADQUARTERS PERSONNEL

Russell Clancy (Grapevine)	Edward H. Bierstadt (Research)	Wilbur A. Smith (C.P.A.)
Arthur Daley (Grapevine)	Ralph W. Bugli (Edit. Cons.)	Nell Wing (Research)
	Dolores Dalziel (Receptionist)	
	Dennis Manders (Controller)	

1954 CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND

<u>U.S.A. STATE</u>	<u>Reported Membership</u>	<u>No. of Groups</u>	<u>No. of Grps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Grps Contrib.</u>	<u>Amt. of Contrib.</u>
Alabama	1,155	43	22	51%	\$ 758.50
Arizona	543	38	21	55	643.50
Arkansas	909	56	35	63	722.00
California	11,645	548	347	63	15,982.59
Colorado	1,822	54	35	65	1,751.00
Connecticut	1,083	50	23	46	991.00
Delaware	314	14	9	64	294.00
Dist. of Columbia	423	9	6	67	356.00
Florida	2,388	128	84	66	3,983.13
Georgia	968	52	28	54	799.50
Idaho	403	26	17	65	478.00
Illinois	7,254	391	350	89	3,670.68
Indiana	1,582	116	71	61	2,332.00
Iowa	1,713	79	48	60	2,197.00
Kansas	1,206	68	40	59	1,466.55
Kentucky	851	59	23	39	1,083.00
Louisiana	782	32	17	53	773.00
Maine	617	40	24	60	582.53
Maryland	945	52	37	71	1,381.50
Massachusetts	2,595	135	93	69	3,269.30
Michigan	3,531	186	125	67	5,113.72
Minnesota	3,323	94	54	57	3,212.46
Mississippi	763	32	23	72	936.00
Missouri	2,260	102	80	78	3,683.00
Montana	346	26	12	46	301.45
Nebraska	386	34	24	70	545.00
Nevada	186	10	4	40	275.00
New Hampshire	242	20	13	65	345.00
New Jersey	2,281	115	67	58	2,440.69
New Mexico	761	38	27	71	777.00
New York	6,942	302	168	56	8,042.75
North Carolina	2,053	104	69	66	2,738.20
North Dakota	505	37	21	57	510.00
Ohio	7,538	315	152	48	5,934.75
Oklahoma	912	58	40	67	3,167.00
Oregon	614	47	32	68	838.00
Pennsylvania	3,319	192	115	60	3,884.64
Rhode Island	331	19	7	37	188.00
South Carolina	895	63	28	44	726.30
South Dakota	530	30	18	60	750.00
Tennessee	735	41	17	41	749.23
*** Texas	4,647	216	141	65	5,774.44
Utah	1,056	45	21	47	424.00
Vermont	337	20	13	65	517.50
Virginia	1,784	79	47	60	2,057.00
Washington	1,437	86	56	65	2,253.68
West Virginia	693	49	24	49	602.50
Wisconsin	1,995	114	76	67	2,432.85
Wyoming	180	20	12	60	215.00
Total for U.S.A.	69,780	4,484	2,816	63%	\$102,949.94

GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND CONTRIBUTIONS
(Continued)

CANADA

Alberta	571	40	25	63%	768.00
British Columbia	1,653	94	44	47	2,977.60
Manitoba	578	27	14	52	603.00
New Brunswick	541	26	8	31	339.50
Newfoundland	114	6	1	17	35.00
Nova Scotia	635	38	14	37	632.00
Ontario	2,866	198	107	55	3,730.61
Prince Edward Is.	97	4	2	50	79.40
Quebec	1,041	73	28	39	855.00
Saskatchewan	562	52	21	40	418.50
Yukon Territory	13	1	1	100	2.00
Total for Canada	8,671	559	265	48%	\$10,440.61
 <u>FOREIGN</u>	 10,651	 441	 58	 13	 1,144.91
 <u>*LONE MEMBERS</u>	 201	 -	 -	 -	 421.89
 <u>INTERNATIONALISTS</u>	 115	 -	 -	 -	 234.40
 <u>ANONYMOUS DONORS</u>	 -	 -	 -	 -	 1,506.85
 <u>**HOSPITAL GROUPS</u>	 4,511	 184	 -	 -	 229.00
 <u>***PRISON GROUPS</u>	 12,128	 259	 -	 -	 300.24
GRAND TOTAL	126,057	5,927	3,139	57%	\$116,805.95

- * Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.
 ** Not included in calculating total percentage of groups contributing.
 *** An additional gift of \$2,343.35 contributed to the Reserve Fund by Texas A.A.'s
 not included in above total.

CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
1955 CONFERENCE FUND
7/1/54 - 5/31/55

<u>U.S.A. STATES</u>	<u>No. of Gps 6/1/55</u>	<u>No. of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Gps Contrib.</u>	<u>Amt. of Contrib.</u>
Alabama	43	9	21%	\$ 55.00
Arizona	41	5	12	35.00
Arkansas	58	11	19	76.00
California	555	117	21	918.00
Colorado	55	13	24	75.00
Connecticut	53	9	17	80.00
Delaware	15	5	33	35.00
Dist. of Columbia	10	3	30	20.00
Florida	129	36	28	258.00
Georgia	56	12	21	97.00
Idaho	27	7	26	67.00
Illinois	399	348	87	515.00
Indiana	116	23	19	175.00
Iowa	79	10	13	165.00
Kansas	70	25	36	213.00
Kentucky	61	8	13	57.00
Louisiana	33	3	9	20.00
Maine	41	7	17	37.00
Maryland	53	17	32	130.00
Massachusetts	135	53	39	330.00
Michigan	190	53	28	432.50
Minnesota	95	27	28	208.00
Mississippi	32	8	25	70.00
Missouri	102	49	48	62.00
Montana	30	1	3	10.00
Nebraska	36	4	11	28.50
Nevada	10	2	20	15.00
New Hampshire	20	3	15	35.00
New Jersey	117	24	21	200.00
New Mexico	36	8	22	55.00
New York	303	52	17	454.00
North Carolina	109	29	27	225.00
North Dakota	37	8	22	52.00
Ohio	317	45	14	372.50
Oklahoma	59	41	69	229.00
Oregon	50	13	26	80.00
Pennsylvania	199	36	18	250.00
Rhode Island	20	8	40	55.00
South Carolina	63	7	11	47.50
South Dakota	31	6	19	40.00
Tennessee	41	5	12	46.25
Texas	226	30	13	251.00
Utah	46	6	13	65.00
Vermont	21	3	14	20.00
Virginia	84	20	24	145.00
Washington	83	24	29	176.64
West Virginia	48	11	23	141.00
Wisconsin	117	26	22	190.00
Wyoming	20	3	15	20.00
Total for U.S.A.	4,571	1,213	27%	\$7,333.89

CONFERENCE FUND CONTRIBUTIONS
(Continued)

CANADA

Alberta	43	13	32%	\$115.00
British Columbia	99	47	47	466.00
Manitoba	27	7	26	55.00
New Brunswick	25	1	4	5.00
Newfoundland	6	1	17	5.00
Nova Scotia	38	4	11	35.15
Ontario	195	56	29	409.10
Prince Edward Is.	4	-	-	-
Quebec	73	15	21	80.00
Saskatchewan	54	4	7	29.05
Yukon Territory	<u>1</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total for Canada	563	146	26.3%	\$1,199.30
GRAND TOTAL	5,134	1,421	27%	\$8,533.19

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

Circulation vs. Reported A.A. Membership

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Reported Membership</u>	<u>Total GV Cir.</u>	<u>% of Members Subscribing</u>	<u>State</u>	<u>Reported Membership</u>	<u>Total GV Cir.</u>	<u>% of Members Subscribing</u>
Alabama	1,155	218	19	Oregon	614	340	55
Arizona	543	213	39	Pennsylvania	3,319	1,253	38
Arkansas	909	299	33	Rhode Island	331	85	26
California	11,645	3,426	29	South Carolina	895	259	29
Colorado	1,822	273	15	South Dakota	530	212	40
Connecticut	1,083	382	35	Tennessee	735	187	25
Delaware	314	85	27	Texas	4,647	1,316	29
Dist. of Col.	423	237	56	Utah	1,056	180	17
Florida	2,388	823	34	Vermont	337	165	49
Georgia	968	329	34	Virginia	1,784	577	32
Idaho	403	149	37	Washington	1,437	563	39
Illinois	7,254	1,302	18	West Virginia	693	322	46
Indiana	1,582	622	40	Wisconsin	1,995	631	32
Iowa	1,713	608	35	Wyoming	180	78	43
Kansas	1,206	445	37	Totals			
Kentucky	851	216	25	of above	89,780	28,047	31%
Louisiana	782	177	23				
Maine	617	253	41				
Maryland	945	363	37				
Massachusetts	2,595	1,261	48				
Michigan	3,531	1,140	32				
Minnesota	3,323	783	24				
Mississippi	763	266	35				
Missouri	2,260	658	29				
Montana	346	111	32				
Nebraska	386	191	50				
Nevada	186	56	30				
New Hampshire	242	137	57				
New Jersey	2,281	991	43				
New Mexico	761	213	28				
New York	6,942	2,835	40				
North Carolina	2,053	702	34				
North Dakota	505	146	29				
Ohio	7,538	1,448	19				
Oklahoma	912	521	57				

CANADA

Alberta	571	282	50
British Col.	1,653	368	22
Manitoba	578	245	42
New Brunswick	541	175	32
Newfoundland	114	20	18
Nova Scotia	635	259	40
Ontario	2,866	1,038	36
Prince Ed. Is.	97	33	34
Quebec	1,041	280	27
Saskatchewan	562	204	36
Yukon Terr.	13	1	8
Totals			
of above	8,671	2,905	34%

1955 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

AGENDA

Vic Maloney, California (Chmn.)
Arnold Neufeld, Wisconsin
Arthur Welch, Maine
Jack Henry, Fort Worth, Texas
Gordon Johnson, North Florida
Gerard Tonies, Springfield, Illinois
(Marian F. - Sec.)

ADMISSIONS TO THE CONFERENCE

Mary Lu Schwarz, New Mexico (Chmn.)
John Kavanagh, Decatur, Illinois
Tom Cardona, Oregon
Winton Green, South Florida
Doc Woods, Minneapolis, Minnesota
Orville Wernitz, Missouri
(Lib S. - Sec.)

CONFERENCE REPORT

Monty Moncrief, Georgia (Chmn.)
Pete DeWeese, Mississippi
Cy O'Neil, Montana
Howard Johnson, Washington State
Pete O'Toole, Newark, New Jersey
Al Hahn, Wyoming
(Lib S. - Sec.)

FINANCE

John Russell, Kansas (Chmn.)
Leon Goode, Tennessee
Doc Caldwell, Rhode Island
Pat Kelly, Milwaukee, Wisconsin
Larry Null, Nevada
Bill Joy, Detroit, Michigan
(Eve M. - Sec.)

GRAPEVINE

Jim Smith, Springfield, Mass. (Chmn.)
Bert Whitehead, Arizona
Bruce Wallace, Maritimes
Dick Caron, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Lane Poe, Oklahoma
Stan Wilsey, San Francisco, California
(Louise S. - Sec.)

LITERATURE

Pat Boyles, Nebraska (Chmn.)
Art Buchanan, New York
Jim Burwell, San Diego, California
Burt Cassady, North Carolina
Clayton Hall, Rochester, New York
Jim Warner, Louisiana
(Hazel R. - Sec.)

POLICY

Henry Marcy, Maryland (Chmn.)
Gil Lamb, Lubbock, Texas
Frank Layne, Kentucky
Cliff Reese, Utah
Charlie Veigle, Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania
Charlie Brown, B. C., Canada
(Marian F. - Sec.)

TRUSTEES

Jim Falloon, District of Columbia (Chmn.)
Ian Gilhuly, Manitoba, Canada
Wendell Haben, Northern Minnesota
~~Hal Davis, New Hampshire~~
Bob Sawyer, Houston, Texas
George Fergeman, Iowa
(Ann M. - Sec.)